

locating No'ah in the valley of Zebabdah, resulting from the identification of No'ah as Kh. Anaḥum (Lemaire 1977: 63; Zertal 1984: 46–47; 2008a: 103; Taylor and Taylor 1992). There is disagreement among scholars regarding I Chr 7 as a source; however, the presentation of Shechem as son of Shemidah allows us to suggest Aniam as a site name.

The PEF surveyors suggested identifying Beth-Hiney – the Onomasticon's Beth-Yanai – as the village of 'Anin (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 44). The identification was based on the distance from Caesarea (15 Roman miles – about 30 km) and the similarity of the names. A tunnel cut for the water of the spring north of 'Anin was discovered by Conder and Kitchener during the survey. They tried to relate it to the description of Beth Hiney as a place of baths (*lavacra*). The identification is likely, considering the finds and distance, but we prefer to locate Beth-Hiney in nearby Qaṣr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah (Site 24). See detailed discussion below.

Another identification is Ianoua of the Onomasticon of Eusebius (no. 544) as the village of 'Anin: "...it is the village of Ianoua three milestones south of Legio." (Taylor 2003: 62). Yet another is the village el-Yamun, but this is too far south, and does not fit linguistically. 'Anin is about 8 km south of Legio, about 4 Roman miles. Ta'anach is at the same altitude as 'Anin, and is also "three miles south of Legio". There is a Byzantine site in the village of 'Anin, the name fits, and there is no other site in the vicinity.

An additional identification is 'Ananin, from the inscription in the synagogue in Rehov, near Beit Shean. The list of permitted townships within the bounds of Sebastiyeh includes Samaritan settlements whose fruits and vegetables were permitted without the fear of impurity. Demsky (1979: 189) tried to identify the 19 towns in the list according to the roads they were situated on, assuming that the roads were trade routes. However, in most cases this assumption is invalid: the towns were organized in groups and not linearly, although there are exceptions in each group. Demsky identified 'Ananin as Kh. Anaḥum close to Zabebdeh only because of its proximity to Shapirin (Sheikh Safiryan).

The similarity between the names 'Anin and 'Ananin support our proposed identification, and allows the extension of the border of Sebastiyeh northwards to Nahal 'Iron: the written sources support this view.

Additional Bibliography: Abel 1967: 274; Avi-Yonah 1976: 68; Sussmann 1981: 166.

Site 24: Qaşr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah

The suggested identification is with Betoaenea or Baitoanaia (Beit-Hiney – Beit Yannai), mentioned twice in the Onomasticon with the same name under the definitions of 'Neiel' (Josh 19: 27; Aneiel in the Onomasticon) and Beth-Anath (Josh 19: 38; Bethanatha in the Onomasticon). The almost identical definitions are: "It is the village of Baitoanaia, situated at a distance of fifteen milestones from Caesarea, in the eastern parts, lying in the mountains, where it is said there are medicinal baths." (Taylor 2003: 24).

The generally accepted identification of Beth-Hinay as the village of 'Anin was first put forward by the SWP: "'Anin, a small village on a ridge... The place appears to be the Betoaenea of the 'Onomasticon', 15 Roman miles from Caesarea in the mountain to the east" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 44). The distance from Caesarea is 23 km (about 12 Roman miles). The distance suits Qaşr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah, where the quality of construction is exceptional for these regions, and there are Byzantine sherds in the site.

Additional Bibliography: Albright 1924: 158; Klein 1939: 15; Luria 1968: 46–59; Avi-Yonah 1976: 37; Dar et al. 1986: 125–126; Tractate Sheviit 7: 14–70.

Site 28: El-Aḥwat

The suggested identification is with Harosheth Ha'goyim (Judg 4: 2, 13), Sisera's last dwelling place. It is mentioned only in relation to the battle of Deborah and Barak against him (Judg 4–5). Mazar has shown that the term 'harosheth' originates in the Akkadian word 'huršānu', meaning forested mountain. In our opinion, the Bible uses the term 'goyim' (gentiles), for describing the northern Sea Peoples (the Shardana and Tjekker) who entered Canaan together with the Philistines.

Harosheth Ha'goyim was identified by Albright (1922) near present Tiv'on, at Tel 'Amr; however, the identification does not fit the geography of the battle and the archaeological finds. The geographical difficulties led the Septuagint and several current scholars (e.g. Mazar 1976a) to equate Harosheth Ha'goyim with Galil Goyim, and to place it in the Lower Galilee. In our view, the Bible meant a fortified city: 'chariots of iron' is synonymous with 'chariot cities', and Sisera's mother expecting her son's return at the window (Judg 5: 28) suits this definition.

Locating Harosheth Ha'goyim at el-Aḥwat corresponds to the advance of the Israelites and Canaanites towards each other, and their encounter on the River Qishon at 'Ta'anach on the waters of Megiddo'. The nature of the fortified locality and its short life also support this identification.

Additional Bibliography: Garstang 1931: 38off; Abel 1967: 21; Zertal 2012.

Site 30: Tel Esur (Assawir)

The identifications of the place with Yehem (Alt 1914) and Arubboth (Alt 1932: 31–34; 1953; Maisler 1935: 80, 82) do not correspond with the new data. The first is geographically incorrect (the identification of Yehem at Kh. Yemmeh is much more convincing), and the second lacks suitable archaeological finds. The new identification of Arbatah/Narbatah as Kh. el-Ḥamam is also preferable to the identification as Kh. Beidus.

We suggest identifying Tel Esur as Djefti, a town on the *Via Maris*, near the entrance to the 'Iron pass. The place was mentioned in the council of the generals of Thutmosis III held at Yehem. The council advises the monarch: "Now two (other) roads are here. One of the roads – behold, it is [to the east of] us, so that it comes out at Ta'anach. The other – behold, it is to the north side of Djefti, and we will come out to the north of Megiddo." (ANET: 235). Aharoni (1958) suggested identifying Djefti as Tell Sit Leila, which, however, is not situated on the road ascending northward, and a major detour is needed to reach it. All the above leads to the identification of Djefti as Tel Esur (Na'aman 1984: 262, note 26). The archaeological finds also support this suggestion.



24. Traditional building with beehives. The stone walls were plastered with mud mixed with dung. Round clay pipes serve as hives, clustered in a small structure (at right). Photo from Preiss and Rohrbach, 1925: 200.

However, this identification raises certain problems. The name, unlike 'Arunah and Megiddo, appears in the Egyptian sources only once. A site so close to the entrance of the 'Iron pass should probably have been mentioned more. In the Bible there is also no mention of the place, and the new excavations at the site revealed that it was sparsely inhabited during the Iron Age (Be'eri 2003: 40–41; Cohen 2003; Zertal 2003: 11). We propose that the main branch of the road was in Wadi Samantar (our road C14), and led directly from Jatt and Burin to 'Arunah. As a result Tel Esur was bypassed, and this could be a likely explanation of why the place was only sparsely inhabited, and therefore not mentioned in the texts.

It is worth noting that Helck's idea (1962: 125) of identifying Djefti as Tell Abu Shusha close to present Mishmar Ha'emeq is illogical because of the distance from the site at Yehem and the incorrect direction.

Additional Bibliography: Albright 1923: 10–11; Abel 1967: 80–82.

Site 38: Tell Ta'anach

The consistent name, the finds, and the location support the accepted identification of the Biblical Ta'anach with the Bronze Age site.

Bibliography: Helck 1962: 125–127; Abel 1967: 22, 59, 73, 80; Stern and Ahituv 1982; Glock 1992; 1993; NEAEHL 5: 2114.

Site 42: Kh. Yannun

The identification with Gintirimmunima of the el-Amarna letters is reasonable (el-Amarna letter 250), since the place is mentioned as being near Ta'anach and the Dothan Valley. The quotation in line 46 of the text fits Kh. Yannun's location at the rim of the cultivated plain of the Jezreel Valley: "He also seized Gittirimmunima, and he cultivated the fi[el]ds of the king, your lord."

Kh. Yannun is rich in Late Bronze Age II finds: both its location and the finds support the identification, and possibly the name has been preserved in that of the village of Rummaneh. This identification of Kh. Yannun also supports the suggested identification of the Levite city of Gath-Rimmon as the village of Rummaneh.

Bibliography: Helck 1962: 197; Abel 1967: 24; Moran 1987: 476, 597.

Site 48: El-Yamun

The identification with *Ianoua* of the Onomasticon (no. 544 [Tylor 2003]; Josh 15: 53: Janum) is unacceptable: "*Ianoum* (Josh 15: 53) Tribe of Judah. Now it is the village of Ianoua three milestones south of Legio. It does not seem to be what is described."

The definition in Josh 15: 53, in the list of Judean cities, is: "And Janun, and Beth-Tappuah, and Aphekah," and it is this source that mentions a village named Janun. The distance from Legio to el-Yamun is 21 km, or 10 Roman miles as the crow flies, and by land even more (see discussion of distances in the Onomasticon – Safrai 1980: 202–203).

In our opinion a more suitable identification of Ianoua or Janunis is the village of 'Anin (see discussion of Site 20).

Additional Bibliography: Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46; Avi-Yonah 1976: 68.

Site 55: Hariqet er-Ras

Identification with Gintiašna of el-Amarna letter 319 is suggested. This is a particularly brief and truncated letter. In the surviving fragment are blessings from a man named Sur-Asar of Gintiašna. Moran (1987: 543) locates it "south-west of Ta'anach"; without additional indications. If indeed it is near Ta'anach then it was possibly one of Gina's daughter towns (Jenin – el-Amarna letter 250: lines 17, 21).

Nahal Qinah, at the outlet of Nahal 'Iron to the Land of Ginah (KUR. Gin-na), is named after Ginah. From the above we learn that Gintirimmunima and Gintiašna were daughter towns of the city of Ginah (The prefix 'Ginti', appears twice more, in Gintikirmil [EA 288–290] and Gittipadlla [EA 250]). If there was a concentration of 'Gintis' in the area of Jenin, then Gintiasna should be identified with Hariqet er-Ras, the only fortified site in the area with many Late Bronze Age finds.

Other el-Amarna sites for identification in the Ta'anach – Dothan Valley region have already been coupled with current names: Burkunah – Burkin, Ḥarabu – el-Khrab, Ginah – Jenin, Nuribdah – Baṭn Umm Nari, and Gintirimmunima – Kh. Yannun; therefore the identification of Gintiasna should be decided by elimination.

Site 57: El-Baṭn

To be identified with Bethomestaim of the Book of Judith, mentioned twice in the book. The first is: "The high priest, Joakim, who was in Jerusalem

at the time, wrote to the people of Bethuliya and Betomesthaim, which faces Esdraelon opposite the plain near Dothan, ordering them to seize the mountain passes, since by them Judea could be invaded; and it would be easy to stop any who tried to enter, for the approach was narrow, wide enough for only two at a time to pass." (Jdt 4: 6–7) (Meeks 1993: 1464). From this quotation it can be concluded that the places were close together, and faced the Jezreel Valley approaches to the Dothan Valley. Accordingly, it is possible to locate the sites fairly reasonably between the Jezreel and Dothan Valleys and 'the great pass to Judea', the Wadi Ḥasan road. The identification of el-Kharaiyyeq with Bethuliya allows the identification of Beth-Homotaim (Betomesthaim) with the fortified tell of el-Baṭn, which contains considerable evidence of Persian presence, and is close to the Wadi Ḥasan road.

The second mention, a more general one, is the flight of Holofernes' army and his supporters: "When the men in the tents heard it, they were amazed at what had happened; Overcome with fear and trembling, they did not wait for one another, but with one impulse all rushed out and fled by every path across the plain and through the hill country; Those who had camped in the hills around Bethulia also took to flight. Then the Israelites, everyone that was a soldier, rushed out upon them; Uzziah sent men to Betomasthaim and Choba and Kola, and to all the frontiers of Israel, to tell what had taken place and to urge all to rush out upon the enemy to destroy them." (Jdt 15: 1–4). Previous researchers shifted the location of the Book of Judith to the Sanur Valley, and suggested identifying Betomesthaim with Sanur, and Bethuliya with Kh. Kheibar (see discussion in Grintz 1957: 104). These ideas lack any geographical basis, since the events took place between the Jezreel and Dothan Valleys, and there is now no reason to consider Sanur.

Additional Bibliography: Moore 1985: 151–153; White 1992b.

Site 59: Kafr Dan

The suggested identification is with Kfar Othnai, on the border between the Galilee and Samaria (Mishna Gittin 7: 7). There is no agreement among scholars as to the location of Kfar Othnai. Robinson (1970, II: 317–318) suggested identifying it as Kafr Kud, appearing in the *Tabula Peutingeriana*. Conder and Kitchener (1882: 45) suggested Kafr Dan. Avi-Yonah (1963: 144–145) went as far as Legio near Megiddo, based upon unconvincing arguments. The location at Kafr Dan is supported by the similarity of the names (the original name is Kafr Adan, which was changed to Kafr Dan in the new Israeli 1/50,000 map, Umm el-Faḥm sheet) and the testimony

of Josephus (War III, iii, 4) according to which the boundary between the Galilee and Samaria went through Ginea, now Jenin. The short distance of Jenin from Kafr Dan (about 5 km) allows its identification as Kfar Othnai.

Additional Bibliography: Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159.

Site 67: Es-Sahlat (B)

The site is probably a military camp from the Persian period. If this is correct, then a connection could be established to the Book of Judith, according to which army camps were set up during the siege of Bethuliya next to the 'great pass to Judea'. This passage is probably Wadi Ḥasan, with sites from the Persian period nearby. Military camps are mentioned in Jdt 7: 6–7; 12: 7; 13: 10, etc (Grintz 1957: 24–26; Moore 1985).

This camp is similar to the Iron Age camp at el-Qa'adeh (Zertal 1993b).

Site 79: El-Kharaiyyeq

The suggested identification is with Bethuliya (Baitilua) of the Book of Judith, a central site and Judith's domicile. It is fortified with a wall on the ridge overlooking the Valleys of Dothan and Jezreel and the narrow Wadi Ḥasan, providing a shorter route than via Jenin. Previous attempts to identify Bethuliya by geographical analysis failed due to the lack of a suitable site and the difficulty of dating the story (see reviews by Moore 1985: 150, and White 1992a).

Bethuliya is mentioned 14 times in the Book of Judith, and the plot occurs in its vicinity. Its location is "...which faces Esdraelon, opposite the plain near Dothan" (Jdt 4: 6). In the next mention (Jdt 6: 10–13) we are told: "Then Holofernes ordered his slaves, who waited on him in his tent, to seize Achior and take him away to Bethuliya and hand him over to the Israelites. So the slaves took him out of the camp into the plain, and from the plain they went up into the hill country and came to the springs below Bethulia. When the men of the town saw them they seized their weapons and ran out of the town to the top of the hill, and all the slingers kept them from coming up by throwing stones at them. So having taken shelter below the hill, they bound Achior and left him lying at the foot of the hill, and returned to their master". There were springs below Bethulia and the town was on the hill: when its inhabitants went out they climbed to the hilltop, and in order to get there passed through the valley. Holofernes' orders were "...to seize the passes up into the hill country..." (Jdt 7: 1). The siege description fits

el-Kharaiyyeq: the camp was in the Dothan Valley, with Bethuliya in the north-west, Dothan and Ibleam in the south-east, Bethuliya in the south, and Cyamon (an unknown place, possibly in the vicinity of Ta'anach) in the north, facing Jezreel.

There is no other place near the Dothan Valley fitting the story descriptions; only in el-Kharaiyyeq are the geographical characteristics to be found. Bethuliya is mentioned only in the Book of Judith, and does not appear before or after. This sole mention fits a single-period site.

Additional Bibliography for previous identifications: Torrey 1899; Dussaud 1926; Steuernagel 1943; Enslin 1972; Priebatch 1974; Craven 1983; Moore 1985: 150–153; 1992.

Site 80: Tell Jenin

Jenin is well identified with a number of important sites: in the el-Amarna letters "The Land of Ginah" is mentioned (EA 250), which is probably the E7 of the 'Execration Texts' (Posener's group); in the Bible there is 'Ein Ganim (see Kallai's opinion in *EB* VI: 207–208) and Beth Hagan (I Kgs 9: 27); in the Book of Judith, it appears as Ginei (Jdt 3: 11) and Ginae of the Roman period appears in Josephus (*Ant.* XX, vi, 1; *War* III, iii, 4); in the Moslem and the Crusader sources it appears under many names: Geninum, Le Grand Gerin, Major Gallina, Gerinum Magnum. These identifications refer to the tell and/or the settlement of Jenin.

Additional Bibliography: Naor 1963; Abel 1967: 24, 62, 225; Aharoni 1979: 57–58, 175–176; Loewenstamm 1978a; Mazar 1980b: 25; Zertal 1992.

Site 93: Khirbet Beidus

Previously identified with Narbatah of the Great Revolt (66 CE) by Mazar (Maisler 1934: 97), who extended Alt's ideas about the Solomonic Third District to the northern Sharon. The similarity in the names Arubboth/Narbatah led Mazar to identify Arubboth at Tel Esur (Site 30), and to search for a nearby Roman site for Narbatah. It led him to Kh. Beidus, already known in the SWP. Josephus (*War* II, xiv, 5) gives a distance of 60 furlongs, about 12 km, between Caesarea and Narbatah. This is the distance between Caesarea and Kh. Beidus, but Avi-Yonah (1963: 22, 63, 126–127; 1976: 82) has shown that the distances in Josephus are between boundaries of toparchies.

The siege works at Kh. el-Ḥamam present a more suitable site for the

identification of Arubboth and Narbatah, and see Site 146.

Additional Bibliography: Abel 1967: 15, 172, 251.

Site 99: Tell esh-Sheikh Şabar

The size of the tell, the Iron Age I and II pottery, and its proximity to the village of Zibdeh, enable identification with a place called Zebed, Zabdi, Zebidah, or Zbadia. The essence of the word **זבד** is 'endowment by God', and the origin is Akkadian. The name might be a derivative of the verb **זבד** (such as Zabad of the family of Ephraim – I Chr 7: 21), and its original name would have been Zabdah.

Bibliography: *EB* II (1978): 894 ('Zavud'); Aloni 1978a; 1978b; Loewenstamm 1978b; 1978c; Shearing 1992.



25. Cobbler, photo from Preiss and Rohrbach 1925: 224.

Site 113: Tell el-'Abeideh

One of the first identifications of Arubboth (I Kgs 4: 10), dropped due to the lack of Iron Age IIA ceramics, and of its not being a major city during Herod's time.

Bibliography: Zertal 1984: 72–84.

Site 122: Khirbet Burin

Mentioned in Shishak's list (no. 33) as Burim, with Gath-Padalla (34), Yehem (35) and Socoh (36). It is likely that the tell was to the west of modern Baqa el-Gharbiyeh (Site 129). The name has been well preserved, and the location fits the order in Shishak's list.

Bibliography: Simons 1937: 89ff, 178ff; Aharoni 1979: 50–51, 325, 327; Kitchen 1973: 432–447; Mazar 1980c: 239.

Site 127: Ferasin

The identification with Kefar Parshai (Avi-Yonah 1963: 128), which appears as Samaritan (Babylonian Talmud 77, 31A), fits the data. The geographical location, the conservation of the name, and the archaeological finds support this identification as Ferasin.

Ferasin could be derived from the Hebrew word פֶּרֶשׁ – equestrian/cavalryman. The name might also be connected to Manasseh's genealogical records, in which Peresh, one of Machir's sons, is mentioned (I Chr 7: 16). The identification is supported by the finds and the name; but the tradition in I Chr 7 rests upon genealogical lists originating on the eastern side of the Jordan, and therefore this suggestion is problematic.

Additional Bibliography: Avi-Yonah 1976: 73; Demsky 1982; Zertal 1984: 42–47.

Site 146: Khirbet el-Ḥamam

Identified with Solomon's Arubboth (I Kgs 4: 10), Arbatta of the Book of Hasmoneans (I Macc 5: 23), and Josephus' Narbatah (War II, xiv, 5; xviii, 10).

The identification is based upon the concept that the Third Solomonic District was in the hill country west of the Jordan. It differs from that of Alt (1953: 77, 82–83) and Mazar (Maisler 1933: 572), who placed the Third District in the Sharon, and extended the First District (Ephraim Hill Country)

up to the Carmel range. Our identification is based upon the identification of Hephher at Tell el-Muḥaffar in the Dothan Valley (Zertal 1984: 65–72; 2004: 71–72), and that of Arubboth as Kh. el-Ḥamam. This fortified site was founded in the 11th–10th centuries BCE (the United Monarchy), and its strategic location, the preservation of the name in ‘Arabbeh, and its fortification system, fit Arubboth.

The name Arubboth survived in the form Arbatta, whose Jewish inhabitants joined Simon the Hasmonean, on his return from Ptolemais to Jerusalem. At this stage the Aramization of the name to Narbatah is straightforward. The siege system testifies to Roman military operations in the 1st century CE. It differs from Josephus’ description of Cestius Gallus’ campaign on the way to Jerusalem in the autumn of 66 CE, which did not mention a siege.

The finds and the other considerations match the historical evidence of the Hellenistic and Roman eras. It seems that the name has been preserved in the large village of ‘Arrabeh, about 5 km to the east.

Additional Bibliography: Albright 1925; Grintz 1947; Aharoni 1962; 1976; Wright 1967; Zertal 1984: 133–137; 1995.

Site 156: Khirbet Barquneh

To be identified with Barqatah (Tal. Avodah Zarah 31: 71). The issue here is the *kashruth* of wines of Jews. From the Babylonian Talmud, Avodah Zarah: “Formerly the ruling was that wine of En-Kusi is forbidden because of Birath-Sirika, that of Borkata is forbidden on account of Kefar-Parshai, and that of Zagdar is forbidden because of Kefar-Shalem” (Epstein 1960: 155).

The corresponding version in the Jerusalem Talmud, Avodah Zarah is: “At first they would rule, the wine of Zigdor [or: Ogedor, in Samaria]—why is it prohibited? Because of Kefar Pagash. And that of Borneta [why is it forbidden]? Because of the town of Soriqah; and that of ‘Ein Kushi? Because of Kefar Shalem” (Neusner 1982: 198).

It is agreed that the three pairs were within the Caesarea district, but their coupling differs in each of the sources:

Babylonian Talmud: ‘Ein Kushi = Birath Suriqah; Barqatah = Kfar Parshai; Zagdor = Kfar Shalim.

Jerusalem Talmud: ‘Ein Kushi = Kfar Shalem; Burgatah = Birath Suriqah; Ugdor = Kfar Pegesh.

Kfar Parshai has been identified by Avi-Yonah (1963: 128; and see a different opinion by Safrai 1980: 226) with Ferasin (Site 127); therefore, it is

necessary to pair it with a nearby settlement retaining the name. The site we suggest is about 5 km from Ferasin, the name Barquneh is similar to Barqatah, and according to Kampffmeyer's rules (Aharoni 1979: 105–130) the suffix could change without alteration of the name itself. In conclusion, it is suggested that Barqunah is Barqatah.

Additional Bibliography: Zertal 1977.

Site 160: Zeita (West)

Was proposed to be *Ha-bi-sa-na* of Thutmosis III, situated between Yehem (Kh. Yemmeh) and Jatt (*k-n-t*) (Helck 1962: 122; Aharoni 1979: 49). At the eastern side of the site are Middle Bronze Age IIB sherds, but none from the Late Bronze Age. An organized and fortified settlement is also absent here. Therefore this identification is no longer valid (we suggest Kh. Rujjum to be *ha-bi-sa-na* – see below).

Site 169: Baṭn Umm Nari

To be identified with Nuribda of el-Amarna letter 365. Nuribda appears together with Shunama in the letter of Biridiya, Prince of Megiddo to Pharaoh Amenhotep IV. The text is as follows: "They do not cultivate in Sunama, and they do not furnish corvée workers. Only I *ia-bu-du-un-ni* (by myself) furnish corvée workers. From Yapu they come, from [my] resources here (and) from Nuribda. And may the king, my lord, take cognizance of his city" (Moran 1987: 560–561; 1992: 363).

Nuribda is located in the area of Megiddo – Shunem – Dothan Valley. There is a possible linguistic link between Late Bronze Age Nuribda and Hellenistic-Roman Narbatah/Arbatah: Nuribda – [N]arboth – Arbatah – Narbatah. The original name Nuribda had changed to Arubboth by omitting the prefix 'N', a phenomenon common in the transcription of Biblical names (see Aharoni's discussion, 1979: 112–119), which has been subject to inaccuracies, omissions, and changes of characters and syllables. The original name was most probably n-r-b-d, and the letter *Nun* was dropped while being copied into the district list. Afterwards it returned to the original form: Narbatah, Narwad, Nabrachtah, etc. Hence, the preservation of the name Arubboth/Narbatah in Kh. el-Ḥamam is regional. As a city (*uru*) of the Bronze Age, it should contain Late Bronze Age finds. In the nearby Dothan Valley all the period's sites have been identified, while Baṭn Umm Nari is close to Kh. el-Ḥamam, is fortified, and has such pottery.

Additional Bibliography: ANET: 485; Helck 1962: 197; Abel 1967: 15.

Site 174: Khirbet Rujjum

The site is a good candidate for the identification of *h-b-d-n*, no. 69 in the list of Thutmosis III. It appears after Yehem (Kh. Yemmeh), and the name has been well preserved in the form 'Ibthan. The 'h' interchanges easily with the Arabic 'a'; the location is also right, but there are no Late Bronze Age I sherds in the site, which is also not fortified. The whole issue is thus unclear.

Bibliography: Simons 1937: 115–119; Helck 1962: 122; Aharoni 1979: 152–166.

Site 179: Kafr Ra'y

Suggested by Horowitz (1923: 149), Alt (1931: 32–33) and Abel (1967: 271) as Beth-'Eqed Haroim (II Kgs 10: 12, 14). The story in II Kings belongs to the Jehu cycle, in which he is commanded to slaughter the brothers of Ahaziah, King of Judah, at the "pit of the shearing house... So Jehu killed all who were left of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, all his leaders, close friends, and priests, until he left him no survivor. Then he set out and went to Samaria. On the way, when he was at Beth-'eqed of the Shepherds, Jehu met relatives of King Ahaziah of Judah and said, who are you? They answered, we are kin of Ahaziah; we have come down to visit the royal princes and the sons of the queen mother. He said, Take them alive. They took them alive, and slaughtered them at the pit of Beth-'eqed, forty-two in all; he spared none of them. When he came to Samaria, he killed all who were left to Ahab in Samaria, until he had wiped them out, according to the word of the Lord that he spoke to Elijah."

Beth-'Eqed (possibly a place for keeping flocks) was on the way from Jezreel to Samaria. Reaching Kafr Ra'y means a considerable detour to the west from road B3, therefore Kafr Ra'y seems unlikely to be Beth-'Eqed, which seems not to have been a settlement, but a well-known cave or pit. In our survey in Kafr Ra'y no Iron Age site has been found.

Eusebius suggested Beth-'Eqed of the Shepherds to have been Bait-hakath (Onomasticon, no. 281), which is probably identical to Beth-Qad: "Baithakath, whence Jehu came. It is a village of Samaria, fifteen miles away from Legio in the great plain". This distance also does not fit Kafr Ra'y.

Additional Bibliography: Dalman 1906: 28–30; Taylor 2003.

Site 198: Khirbet Shuweiket er-Ras

The location of the site, at the crossroads of the *Via Maris* (Aphek – Megiddo) and the transverse road along Nahal Shechem, is the reason for its geographical importance. The place is mentioned as *Su4-ku* (no. 67) in the list of Thutmosis III, in the expeditions of Amenhotep II, in lists of towns (el-Amarna letter 70) of Ramses II, and in Shishak's list (no. 38). It had been identified correctly with Socoh of Solomon's Third District (I Kgs 4: 10).

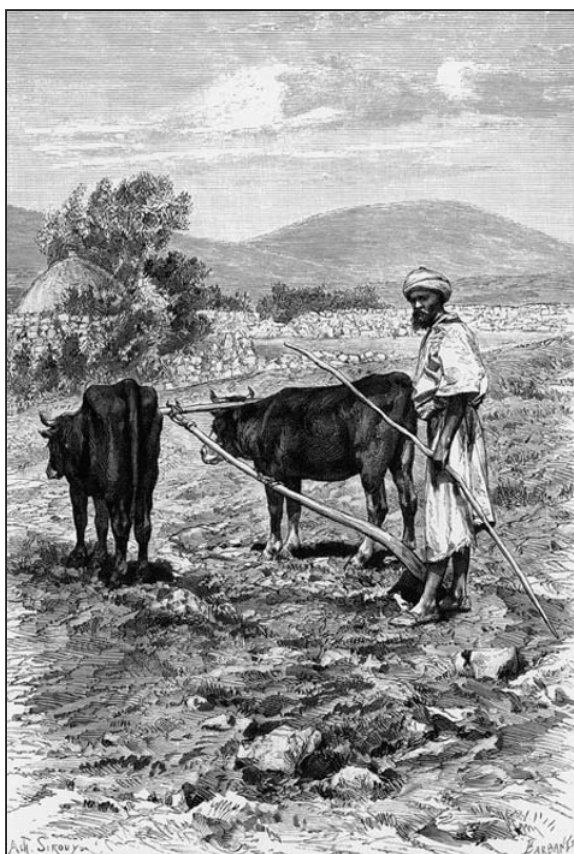
Bibliography: ANET: 243, 246; Helck 1962: 122; Abel 1967: 467; Alt 1966: 147–148; Aharoni 1979: 24–25, 48–52, 161, 166–168, 311–314, 325, 327; Mazar 1976b: 148, 152; 1976c: 155–156, 158; Kallai 1982: 284; Zertal 1984: 28–29, 34, 40, 48, 70, 73, 82.

PART TWO
DESCRIPTION OF THE SITES

CHAPTER THREE

NAHAL 'IRON (WADI 'ARAH)

LANDSCAPE UNIT 22



26. Ploughing with oxen, etching from *La Syrie d'aujourd'hui* by L. Lortet (Paris, 1884).

Site 1: 16-21/88/1

'Ein Qūṭein

Israel grid: 1683 2181

UTM grid: 7058 6045

Elevation: 155 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest settlement

Site type: sherd scatter and
olive presses

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: moderate slope

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Qūṭein (no. 135),
300 m distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 600 m
distant

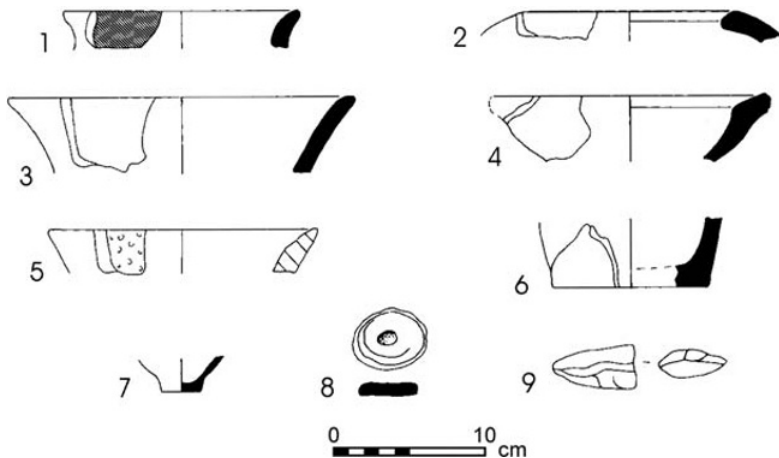
Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Aug. 1992; 27 sherds

A small site on a slope west of Kibbutz Giv'at 'Oz, in the western part of a pine forest; there is a view of the wadi and 'Ein Qūṭein.

The site has a Chalcolithic sherd scatter. In the centre of the area are two rock-cut installations for crushing olives, and ten cupmarks next to them. Next to the southern installation is a structure with two corners of a wall made of medium-sized stones. The above appears to have been part of an 'industrial area' or farm.

A salvage excavation 300 m to the south-west (Israel grid: 1680/2178), by Aizik (Aizik and Peleg 2009b) revealed 40 pits in the rock, without any



27. Finds from 'Ein Qūṭein (Chalcolithic): 1. Bowl, rd slip; 2. HM, brn; 3-4. Bowls, yel; 5. Bowl, basalt; 6. Bowl base, brn; 7. Small bowl; 8. Disc; 9. Flint adze.

dateable finds.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 66%; Late Roman – 34%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 7.



Site 2: 16-21/67/2

El-Ḥamarrah

Israel grid: 1660 2171

UTM grid: 7035 6034

Elevation: 290 m a.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest settlement

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop and slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: Terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Sliman, 800 m distant

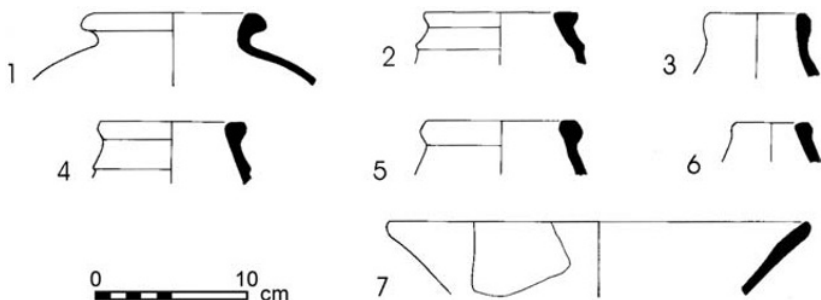
Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 500 m distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Sept. 1992; 30 sherds

A site in an olive grove on the southern slope of the 'water tank hill' in the village of el-Murtafa'ah. The site is 1 km north-west of the village of Zalafeh el-Gharbiyeh.

The sherd scatter on the built terraces and hill slope indicates the existence of several houses in the past. Sherds are also scattered in the olive



28. Pottery from el-Ḥamarrah: 1.Jar, yel, Pers; 2-6.Jars and jugs, brn, IA II; 7.Bowl, gr, Pers.

grove and down to the wadi. This may have been a subsidiary site of the large site of el-Martefah, mentioned by Guérin (1969b: 232).

Pottery: Iron II – 70%; Persian – 30%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 31; 2006: site 31.

Additional Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 2.



Site 3: 16-21/77/1

Zalafeh el-Gharbiyeh (on British Survey map: Zelefeh)

Israel grid: 1673 2172	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 7049 6036	Cultivation: partial
Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: about 60 (in village)
Name type: Arab village	Water source: Bir Zalafeh (no. 2), in the site
Site type: village on top of ruin	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 1.5 km distant
Area: 25 dunams (2.5 ha)	Visibility: 3
Topography: slope and valley rim	Date of visit: Aug. 1992; 60 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: Terra rossa and alluvium	

A village on the southern slope of Zalafeh range, on the western fringes of the Jezreel Valley. The village overlooks and slopes downward into a small inner valley, an extension of the Jezreel Valley. An asphalt road leads into it from the main Jenin–Megiddo road. Olive trees are planted all around.

The ancient core of the village, situated half-way up the slope, has been obliterated completely by new construction. Here and there parts of old walls, cisterns and remnants of Ottoman period buildings can be seen, but most of the ruins are long gone.

Pottery was meticulously collected from the slopes and ravine at the foot of the village in the north. Presumably the inventory of these sherds offers a reliable picture of the village's history.

The village does not appear in the Ottoman census of 1596. Guérin writes (1969b : 232) “At 10:25 we crossed a small stream named Wadi Zalafeh, and ignored at our left a miserable village which we assumed had the same name, almost completely deserted” [translated from French, A.Z.].

The British Survey mentions “A small ruined village with a well” (Conder

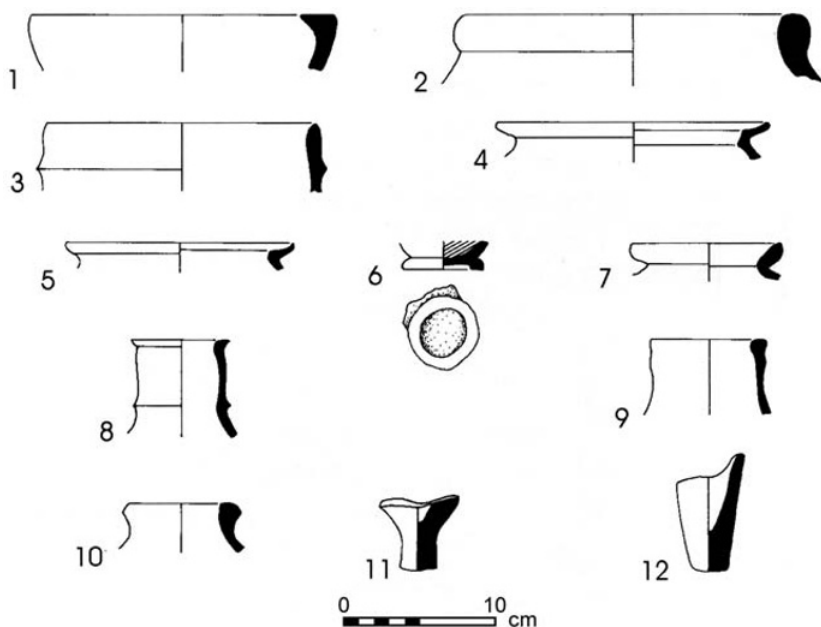
and Kitchener 1882: 72). According to the archaeological finds, the place was settled continuously from the Iron Age period until today, with a noticeable decline during the Ottoman period.

Pottery: Iron Age – 5%; Persian – 5%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 20%; Ottoman – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 32; 2006: site 32.

Additional Bibliography: Meron and Kabha 1993: 70; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 4.



29. Pottery from Zalafeh el-Gharbiyeh: 1.Bowl, lt, Pers; 2-3.Pithoi, brn, IA I; 4-5. Bowls, brn, ER; 6.Sigillata jug, Rom; 7.Jar, lt, Pers; 8.Jar, dk rd, ER; 9.Jar, brn, Byz; 10.Jar, lt, Pers; 11-12.Unguentarium, Hel.

Site no. 4: 16-21/66/1

Khirbet 'Aqqadeh (on British Survey map: Akkadeh)

Israel grid: 1662 2164

UTM grid: 7037 6029

Elevation: 288 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as ruin
and Arab village

Site type: village on small tell

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: Terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Musmus
(no. 141), 1.2 km distant

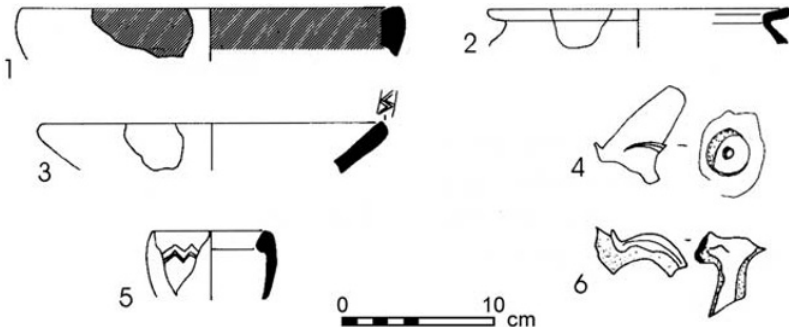
Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 800 m
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Aug. 1992; 60 sherds

A small village on a ruin in the hilly area between Umm el-Faḥm and the Nahal 'Iron road. Near the village is the beginning of Wadi Mash'arah which flows north to the Jezreel Valley.

In the modern village are about ten houses, built upon and in a few stone houses and hovels from the British or Ottoman periods. On the terraces on the eastern side of the village, on the slope, among olive trees, sherds from the Roman/Byzantine periods are scattered. There are also a rock-cut cistern and an especially large winepress with a must pit, 1×1 m, 2 m deep. Near the village, to the west, are a sacred oak tree and the tomb of a saint, Hajj Mahwi. About 50 m to the north is an artificial cave. In the British Survey the village is described as "ruined buildings, apparently modern" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 51). An old man at the site said that the village



30. Khirbet 'Aqqadeh Pottery: 1. Bowl, shiny brn slip, MA; 2. Bowl, brn, ER; 3. Bowl, dec rim, lt, MA; 4. Jug nozzle, blk, Ott; 5. Jug, incised dec, blk, Ott; 6. Jar handle, dk, Byz.

was nearly 400 years old.

Pottery: Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 50%; Middle Ages – 10%; Ottoman – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.



31. Khirbet 'Aqqadeh, general view looking south-west, 1992. Photo: A. Zertal.



Site 5: 16-21/76/1

Wadi Suweisseh

Israel grid: 1679 2166

UTM grid: 7054 6030

Elevation: 200 m a.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest settlement

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: slope and wadi

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: Terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir Zalafeh (no. 2),
700 m distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 1.5 km
distant

Visibility: 1

Date of visit: Aug. 1992; 38 sherds

A sherd scatter in a ravine, next to the Wadi Suweisseh channel, and about 0.5 km south of the centre of the village of Zalafeh esh-Sharqiyeh.

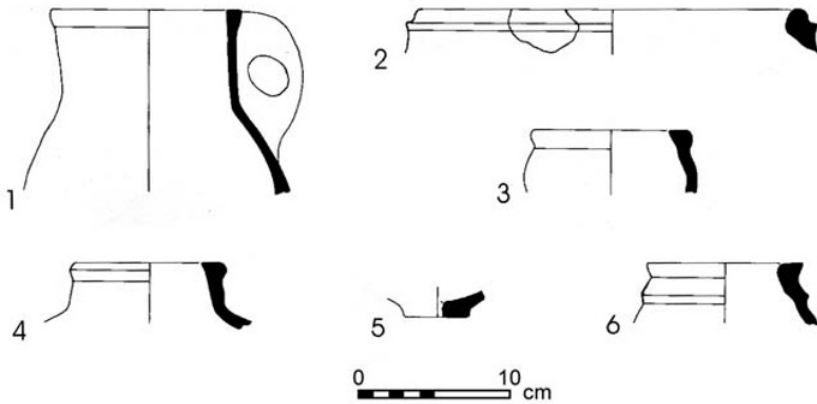
Homogeneous sherds are scattered on the northern slope of the wadi; here and there are remains of structures in the form of wall sections that have been almost entirely dismantled in order to cultivate the land. The whole site is terraced and cultivated. It appears that the terrace foundations are ancient and houses once stood on them. Next to the site is a saddle with a built path descending southward from the village of Zalafeh esh-Sharqiyeh toward Salem.

Several Iron Age houses once stood here. The site was possibly connected to the large site at Salem.

Pottery: Iron Age II – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 3.



32. Wadi es-Suweissh pottery (IA II): 1. Jug, gr; 2. CP, brn; 3-4, 6. Jars, gr; 5. Bowl base, yel.

Site no. 6: 16-21/96/1

Salem (Village)

Israel grid: 1691 2162

UTM grid: 7066 6026

Elevation: 193 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient Arab village

Site type: Arab village on large tell

Area: village and tell – 120 dunams
(12 ha)

Topography: low hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: Terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: olive groves

Cisterns: in village – 60; on tell – 10

Water source: Bir Sallim (no. 145),
800 m distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 700 m
distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Sept. 1992; 187 sherds

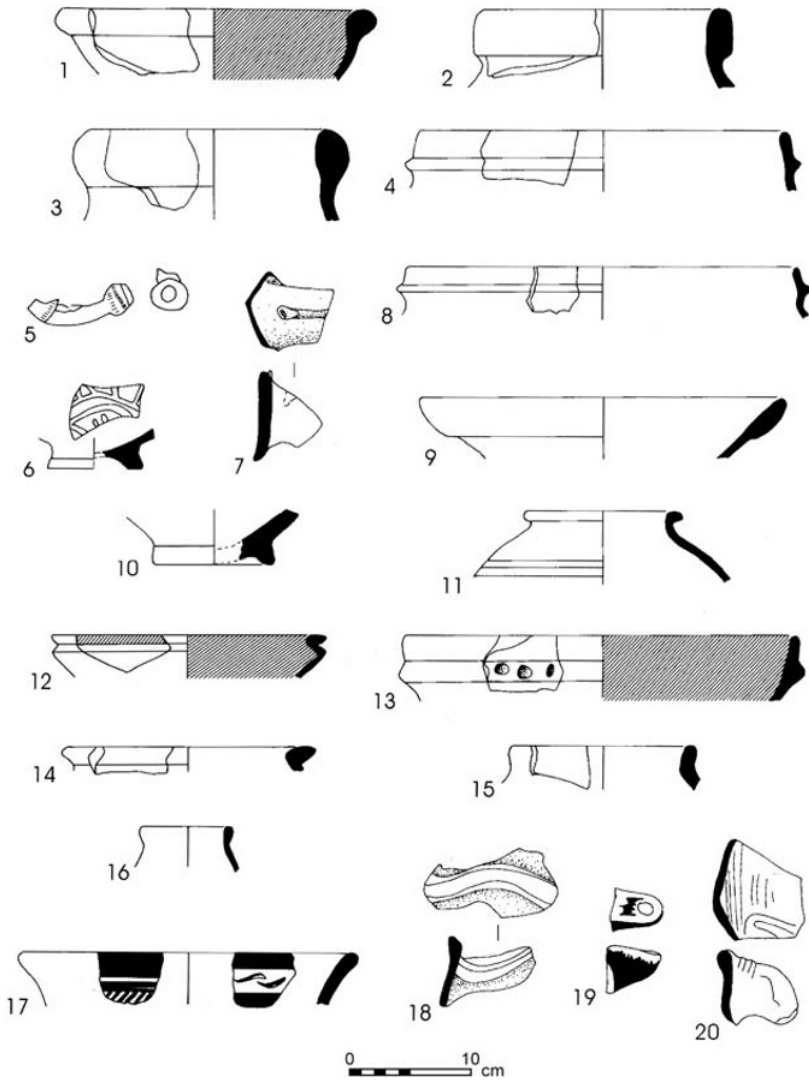
A village on a large tell in the inner, western fringes of the Jezreel Valley. It is situated in a hilly area, about 3.5 km south-east of Megiddo Junction, and 5 km east of Umm el-Faḥm.

Both the village and the tell are situated on a large, low hilltop, part of the foothills that ascend from the edges of the Jezreel Valley westward. At the top part of the hill is a small, ancient settlement core, now completely in ruins, in which Sheikh Ḥamdan is buried in a modest structure resembling a hut with a stone dome.

A narrow approach road leads to the village from the Jenin–Megiddo road. Next to it is a water source, Bir Sallim. The new houses of the village are scattered over the hilltop and its slopes. In the area of the ancient core, many sherds dating from the Middle Ages and later were collected. On a large area around this core, a considerable number of sherds were collected from the ancient tell in a strip to the south, east and north. In the olive groves surrounding the village there are scattered building stones and sections of walls. Many rock-cut installations were found, as well as cisterns and plundered burial caves.

There is a large tell here, more than 100 dunams (10 ha) in area, in the centre of which is the core of the later village. The building stones of the ancient site were dismantled when the area was made ready for planting olive trees and the new village was established. The place was an important site during the Iron and Persian periods, corresponding to Megiddo and Ta'anach.

In 1596 the village of Salem was in the Shar'ah province, and had nine Moslem taxpayers. The village paid taxes of 2100 *aqia* for wheat, 1040 *aqia*



33. Pottery from Salem (village and ancient tell): 1. Bowl, rd on brn, ER; 2-3. Pithoi, gr, IA I; 4. CP, dk, IA I; 5. Pipe, yel, Ott; 6. Bowl, glaze and dec, MA; 7. Jar handle with perforation, brn, IA I; 8. CP, dk, IA I; 9. Bowl, yel, Pers; 10. Jug, dk brn, IA I; 11. Jar, brn, IA II-Pers; 12. Bowl, green glaze, MA; 13. Bowl, rd coating and slip, IA II (?); 14. Jar, gr, IA II; 15. Jar, lt brn, IA II-Pers; 16. Jug, blk, Byz; 17. Bowl, blk on wh, Mam (MA); 18. 'Frying pan' handle, brn, Byz; 19. Oil lamp nozzle, blk, Hel; 20. Jar handle with incisions, lt, Pers.

for barley, 700 *aqia* for olive trees, 200 *aqia* for goats and honey, in total, 4300 *aqia* (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159).

Guérin (1969b: 230–232) discussed the identification possibilities at length, “At 10:15 we passed Salem. As the name witnesses, it was surely built at the site of the ancient settlement named Salem. There are now not more than 150 residents, and it sits on a hill from which the view encompasses a considerable part of the Jezreel Valley. As for the city of Salem, as far as I know it is not mentioned at all in the Scriptures or other ancient writings, unless there is a basis for the assumption that it is the city mentioned in the Book of Judith with the settlements that the Jews fortified when Holofernes approached, so as to delay his journey towards Jerusalem (Judith 4:4-5).” Further on, Guérin writes, “At 10:17 we descended northwards from the hill of the village of Salem, and incidentally we saw on the side of this hill very clear distinct traces of ancient buildings” [translated from French, A.Z.].

The British Survey states: “A small village standing above the road, with a well to its north” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 45, 68). This description raises the question of the pathway, since the Jenin–Megiddo road, according to the British Survey’s Sheet VIII, is identical to today’s road. In another place they point out: “Guérin found very distinct traces of ancient buildings.”

According to Meron and Kabha (1993: 68), a considerable portion of the lands close to the village were Wakf lands of Sheikh Salem.

Gophna and Porath (1972: no. 1) identified only the later ruin in the centre of the village.

Pottery: Iron I – 4%; Iron II – 14%; Persian – 33%; Hellenistic – 10%; Roman – 6%; Byzantine – 11%; Early Moslem – 4%; Middle Ages – 14%; Ottoman – 4%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 1.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 20; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 9; Salem 2006: site 291.

Site 7: 16-21/55/1

Khirbet Umm el-'Abhar

Israel grid: 1657 2158	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7033 6021	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 360 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: on map as historical site	Water source: 'Ein Musmus (no. 141), 1.2 km distant
Site type: remains of structures	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Visibility: 4
Topography: moderate slope	Date of visit: Sept. 1992; 15 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: Terra rossa	

A small site on the high part of a moderate slope of the range to the east of Umm el-Faḥm, about 900 m west of the village of el-'Aqqadeh.

At the site are a few very sparse and poor remains of mud brick walls with passages between them. The place is now cultivated and planted, and little of the settlement remains. Only after considerable efforts were we able to find a few sherds.

This is a subsidiary site of 'Aqqadeh or Umm el-Faḥm. Its name indicates the presence of terebinth trees in the area.

In the British Survey it was described as "a few mud hovels on the hill-top" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 70). It seems that by the beginning of the 20th century the village was no longer in existence.

Pottery: Ottoman – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 8: 16-21/95/1

Salem (Tell)

Israel grid: 1692 2159	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7067 6023	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 140 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 3
Name type: nearest settlement	Water source: Bir Sallim (no. 145), 1 km distant
Site type: medium-sized tell	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 1 km distant
Area: 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)	Visibility: 4
Topography: edge of hill extension	Date of visit: July 1993; 80 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: Terra rossa and rendzina	

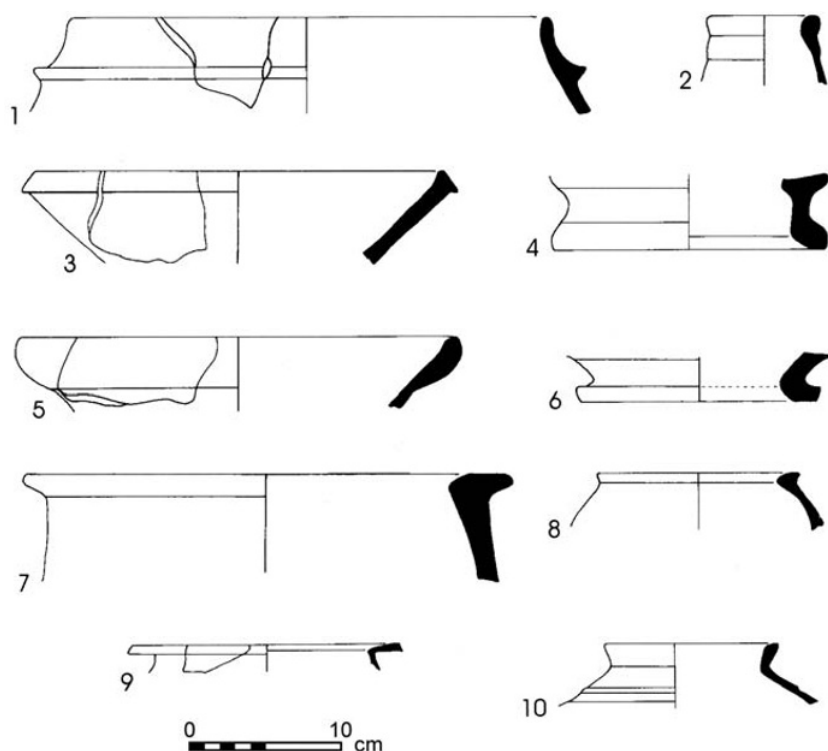
A tell on the edge of a ridge with olive trees planted on it, in the hilly area about 700 m south of the centre of the modern village of Salem. The ridge is isolated by deep ravines to the east, south and west. It can be reached conveniently only from the north. A patrol road from Salem to Barṭa'ah passes 400 m from the site.

The site is divided into a prominent upper part (an 'acropolis') and the rest of the tell. Its general contour is oval, with sharp corners and angles. On the west side possible remains of fortification were found: a wall built of large stones, which was preserved to a height of about 1 m. It is difficult to ascertain whether this is a city-wall or a terrace wall, but we tend toward the former option. This wall begins in the west and turns south at a sharp angle. After about 150 m it makes another sharp turn eastward, where it towers over a deep ravine. The eastern part of the site is 3–4 m lower than the western part (the 'acropolis'). The latter may also have been fortified since it stands out topographically. At the north-eastern part, the site towers up to 8 m above the ravine. Considerable numbers of building stones and sherds are scattered all around. In the south-western part, two bell-shaped cisterns were found. Next to them are cut basins, cupmarks and a large cave. Another cave was found in the north-eastern part of the 'acropolis'. In many places at the site signs of quarrying were found on the exposed rock. Here and there a few remains of walls of the original houses at the site could be seen.

During 2002 a number of excavations took place in the northern slope of the tell (Israel grid 1689 2159) by Cohen and Haiman (2008). A short description follows:

1. Four winepresses cut into bedrock were excavated. An example is an

- installation, where there is a trapezoidal treading floor (3.8×3.8×3.6×2.5 m, 3-10 cm deep) and a rectangular collecting vat (1.3×0.5 m, 0.6 m deep).
2. Four burial caves were excavated. An example is a cave, where a courtyard (4.5×2.5 m) with benches 0.3 m high was excavated. The cave opening is at the west side of the courtyard. Steps descend into a burial chamber (4×4 m, 2 m high), in which three burial shelves were cut – one on each side of the opening and one facing it. Until recently the cave was used as living quarters and for storage. A Roman (2nd–4th century CE) oil lamp, three 3rd century CE coins and a few human bones were found.
 3. Two water cisterns were excavated: in site 13; a hewn cistern with a rectangular opening (0.5×0.5 m, seemingly 0.6 m deep), and the other bell-shaped (6×3 m, 6 m deep) with a rectangular opening (1.5×1.0 m).
 4. Other remains include a quarry (20×20 m) and a sherds scatter not far from caves 53/3 and 53/4. The sherds are dated to the Late Roman and



34. Tel Salem Pottery: 1.CP, brn, IA Ic; 2.Jar, brn, IA II; 3, 5.Bowls, gr, Pers.; 4, 6.Mortaria bases, yel, Pers; 7.Basin, gr, Pers; 8.Bowl, brn, IA II-Pers; 9.Bowl, brn, Herodian; 10.Jar, yel, IA II.

Byzantine Periods.

Pottery: Iron I – 40%; Iron II – 10%; Persian – 25%; Hellenistic – 10%; Roman-Byzantine – 10%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Identification: This is possibly the ancient core of the large tell of the village of Salem. This supposition is based on the high proportion of ceramics from the Iron Age, which is greater than that of the finds of the large tell of Salem. The tell under discussion comprises part of a rich complex of sites from the Iron and Persian periods in the area. A reasonable proposal for the identity of this complex is the Israelite settlement of Salem in the Book of Judith (4:4): see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 8.



Site 9: 16-21/54/1

Edh-Dhahr

Israel grid: 1654 2148

UTM grid: 7030 6011

Elevation: 350 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest settlement

Site type: structure or farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Iskander (no. 8),
1 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.2 km
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: July 1993; 23 sherds

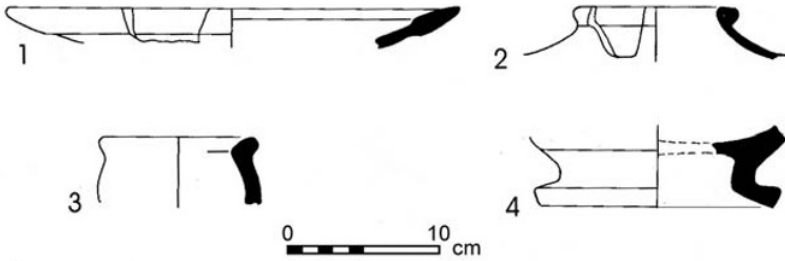
A small site on a wide slope that descends southwards from the edh-Dhahr range to the rift of Wadi Hanukh. The eastern entrance road to Umm el-Faḥm runs through this wadi.

The site is situated on the eastern slopes of the large village of Umm el-Faḥm, about 500 m north-west of Khirbet 'Amasi. Among the olive groves, on the slope near the eastern buildings of the village, a large, single-period sherd scatter and a few building stones were found. Several buildings once stood on this spot, which were dismantled for the purpose of cultivating the orchards.

Pottery: Persian: 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 28; 2006: site 28.



35. Edh-Dhahr pottery (Persian): 1.Bowl, gr; 2-3.Jars; 4.Mortaria base, yel.



Site 10: 16-21/64/1

Darb el-Fa'ur (on modern map: Kh. 'Amasi; appears nameless in British Survey)

Israel grid: 1661 2143

UTM grid: 7037 6006

Elevation: 384 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historical site

Site type: large ruin

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: high hilltop

Rock type: Judah group, volcanic tuff

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Iskander (no. 8), 1 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2 km distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Aug. 1992; 50 sherds

A large ruin on the northern half of the Darb el-Fa'ur hill about 1.5 km north-east of the centre of Umm el-Faḥm. Most of the hill is built up, or is now under construction.

The flat-topped hill towers steeply above its environs, and Wadi es-Suweisseh begins at its foot to the north. A considerable number of sherds, mainly from the Persian period, were found on the north-eastern part of the hill. Building remains were not found, since they were uprooted for cultivation and contemporary construction. In the middle of the site is

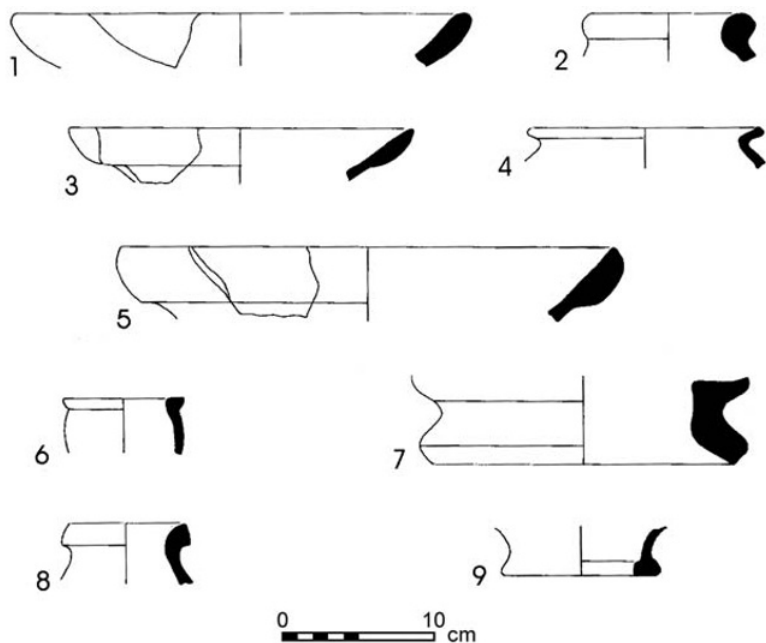
a very large pile of stones collected from the ancient site. In the south-eastern part of the hill, a place in which a new suburb has been built, a few sherds from the Roman-Byzantine period were collected.

This is a large site in the area of Umm el-Faḥm, which flourished especially during the Persian period. The ancient settlement, which was unfortified, was on a dominant hill.

Pottery: Persian – 45%; Hellenistic – 15%; Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 30; 2006: site 30.



36. Darb el-Fa'ur pottery (all Pers except no. 4): 1, 3, 5. Bowls, gr and yel;
2, 6, 8, 9. Jars and jugs; 4. Bowl, Rom; 7. Mortaria base, yel.

Site 11: 16-21/84/1

Wadi eṭ-Ṭaiybeh

Israel grid: 1682 2143

UTM grid: 7058 6007

Elevation: 220 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest settlement

Site type: farm?

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: olive groves

Cisterns: 1

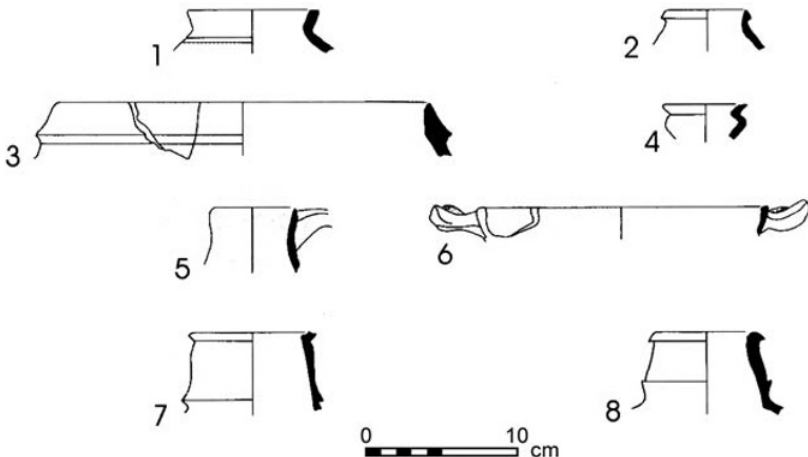
Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
2.5 km distantRoad: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 2.8 km
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Aug. 1993; 30 sherds

A small site on a high southern slope of the hilltop at E.P. 227, in the hilly area between Umm el-Faḥm and the Jenin–Megiddo road. The hilltop is situated between deep wadis, Wadi eṭ-Ṭaiybeh to the south and the Nahal Rimoni to the north. The site is situated about 3 km east of Umm el-Faḥm.

Concentrations of sherds, mosaic stones, and fragments of glass were found inside the young olive orchard on the slope. No walls were found. North of the cultivated area are remains of a building made of large stones, and a pile of building stones that were cleared from the cultivated area when it was being prepared for planting. It can be postulated that there



37. Pottery from Wadi eṭ-Ṭaiybeh: 1. Jar, brn, LR; 2. Jug, yel, ER; 3. CP, brn, IA I; 4. Small bowl, ER; 5. Jug, brn, Rom; 6. 'Frying pan', brn, Byz; 7. Jar, ER; 8. Jar, LR.

was a farm with installations on the spot. The rock-cut installations found nearby to the south are to be associated with this farm, as is the ancient water cistern (still in use) on the eastern slope. Next to the site, to the west, a burial cave opening was found.

This is a complete farm with installations, which was dismantled for the most part to clear the land for orchards.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 12%; Persian – 3%; Roman-Byzantine – 85%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 6.



Site 12: 16-21/94/1

Rummaneh

Israel grid: 1695 2145

UTM grid: 7071 6009

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l.,
60 m b.s.a.

Name type: ancient

Site type: Arab village on ruin

Area: of ancient core – 10 dunams
(1 ha)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: Terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 50
(in ancient core)

Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
1 km distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2),
1.3 km distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: repeated, 1980-85;
no sherds collected

A medium-sized village in a ravine at the foot of a hill at E.P. 184; part of the low hills at the fringes of the Jezreel Valley. The ancient core is relatively well preserved, and contains some houses from the Ottoman period, water cisterns, rock-cut graves, etc. It was not surveyed, but was visited by us several times.

In 1596 the village was in the Shar'ah province and had 12 Moslem taxpayers, who paid taxes of 7200 *aqia* for wheat and barley, and 700 *aqia* for olives (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159).

In the British Survey it is described as: "Rumaneh – A small village of mud and stone, near the foot of the hills, with wells to the west and olives below. This village seems to mark the site of Maximianopolis, a town, 20 Roman

miles from Caesarea (*Itin. Hierosol.*), and 10 miles from Jezreel (Zer'in). The ancient name of Maximianopolis being, according to Jerome, Hadad Rimmon (Comm. in Zech. xii.11). Rummaneh is 18 English miles from Caesarea, and 7 ½ English miles from Zer'in (Jezreel, Sheet IX)." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 45).

Guérin (1969b: 228–230) describes (14 June 1870): "a small village, which I had already visited in 1863. It now has only about 20 shabby houses. Aside from a few water cisterns cut into the rock and one well, I saw no antiquities" [translated from French, A.Z.]. Later he explains the identification of Hadad Rimmon; see Chapter 2.

According to Avi-Yonah (1976: 91), this was the location of the Talmudic settlement of Rimmon (Tosefta Ohalot 15: 13); see Chapter 2. Grossman (1986: 349) notes (without reference) that some of the residents came from Ya'bad, Ra'y and Deir el-Ghuṣun, some from Egypt, and others were Bedouin from the Tabor.

In 1931 there were 644 residents and 151 inhabited homes (Vilnay 1968: 367).

Identification: Suggested identifications are Gath Rimmon, one of the Levite cities (Josh 21:24–25; I Chronicles 6:54), Hadad Rimmon (Zech 12:11) and Talmudic Rimmon; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 44.

Site 13: 15-21/72/1

Tell 'Arah ('Arunah) and in British Survey: Kh. Arah

Israel grid: 1579 2123	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 6956 5985	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 10 (in houses)
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Water source: Bir el-Miskeh (no. 148), on site
Site type: tell	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), next to site
Area: 50 dunams (5 ha)	Visibility: 4
Topography: hilltop and edge of ridge	Date of visit: repeated 1980-90; 200 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: brown forest, terra rossa	

A prominent tell in the modern village of 'Arah, just north of the Hadera–'Afula highway (Route 65).

The tell is separated by ravines from the hills to its north and east. Its top, about 10 dunams (1 ha) in area, is not built up; nor is the large northern slope, which is composed of steps on which olive trees grow. The lower part of this slope has a saddle shape on which there is a considerable sherd scatter. On the tell's top and northern slope is an old grove of olive trees, while on the steep southern slope is a young grove. There are now modern buildings on the southern and western slopes. Here and there remains of ancient walls are discernible, but there is no remnant of the original fortification which surrounded the site. The ancient core, from the Middle Ages onward, was on the western slope of the tell. The tell's top is called el-Bureij to this day, which was the name of the Crusader fortress that once stood here: see the discussion under the entry on 'Ar'arah (Site 22).

Apparently there was also a lower city, which extended to the south and east, and whose perimeter is as yet unknown. At the foot of the tell, to the east, is a well (Bir el-Miskeh). Structures from the Roman and Ottoman periods which also once stood here, were destroyed by later building. From the top of the tell is a fine view to the south of the 'Ar'arah Valley and the ranges around it.

The first historical information about the village is found in the Ottoman 1596 census (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159). In the village were two Moslem taxpayers, who paid 1800 *aqia*, including 1400 for wheat and the rest for other produce. The modern village was apparently founded



38. Tell 'Arah ('Arunah) seen from the west. On the tell is an olive grove. Photo: A. Zertal.

at the beginning of the 16th century, since it is not mentioned in Baibars' list. In the British Survey there is a description of the place (including the village of 'Arah), as: "Traces of ruins on a prominent mound with a well" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 57).

Albright visited here in 1923 with an expedition from the American School for Biblical Studies, describing it as follows:

"Entering the valley we followed the pass towards the north, and soon reached Tell 'Ara, with the modern village of 'Ara at its foot. Hellenistic and Roman sherds reminded us that Josephus calls the town Aros, while an examination of the slopes of the tell produced some fine sherds of the Late Bronze and Early Iron Periods, testifying to a Bronze Age settlement, which continued during the Israelite Period. This Bronze Age settlement is called 'Aron (for the linguistic change cf. Kesalon and Kesla, etc.) in the Egyptian texts of Tuthmosis III, as pointed out by Alt. Here again the Egyptian account is so detailed that the identification would be certain, even without the archaeological confirmation – which is, none the less, welcome." (Albright 1923: 10–11).

In 1951 F.M. Abel (1951: 49–51) visited the place and wrote:

"In his commentary on the Book of Joshua, Noth wrote (in connection with the name 'Arah) that the place name was deeply rooted but was unknown. Possibly it is based on the form 'until the cities of the Sidonites', since if one uses all the basics of the phrase one reaches the logical conclusion, upon

the background of the general association, as follows: 'And from 'Ara that is beside the Sidonim, as far as Afeq, to the border of the Emori' (Joshua 13:4). In the conception of the final editor of the Bible, 'Arah was north of the northernmost Philistine Satrapy which was Eqrn. This brings us to the well-known Via Maris, over which Egyptian armies passed in their travels to Megiddo, from Socho near Tulkarm to Yehem (Yemmeh) and from there to Tel Assawir where the water sources were. There they turned to Wadi 'Arah, a convenient road descending from Umm el-Fahm to Megiddo. Just 30 years ago there was not even one village along the passage of Wadi 'Arah, with the exception of the small cluster of shacks of 'Ar'arah on the heights of the southern slope on the King's Way. It appears that this place came into being due to the desire of the inhabitants to distance themselves from the road, which was infested with bandits. In any case, 'Ar'arah has no ancient site. Tel 'Arah, in contrast, is entirely different. It is located about halfway between Tel Assawir and 'Ein Ibrahim; it is connected by a ridge to the range north of it, and the rest of its slopes are pretty steep. It is on the strategic path, and its water sources and agricultural land surrounding it made it a central spot during the earliest periods. Here, after hundreds of years of slumber, 'Arah has awoken and acquired its importance and its original name. In addition, another village, named Wadi 'Arah, is being created to the west of the traditional village of 'Arah. Is it surprising that the Book of Joshua preserved the original name?

It seems to me that the original Egyptian name, *rn* 'this city', bore the name Aran in ancient times. Did the *n* separate two consonants? Between the Egyptian and Hebrew pronunciation, in my opinion the latter is preferable, but it seems that both are possibilities. The example of Shiloh proves this; the *n* can be present or absent (Shiloh-Shilon and in Arabic Silwan). In the same manner, the form 'Arah is possible, as well as the transformation to the Hebrew 'Iron. Egyptologists have dealt with the question of the identity of 'Arah, mentioned by Thutmosis III, the Anastasi Papyrus [untrue! A.Z.] and no. 32 of the Shishak List. Guthyere gives all the transliterations of the name, from *rn* to *anaraa*, but it seems that the simplest form is the most correct. The city, which stood on the main road to Megiddo in the central part of the Carmel [!? – A.Z.], was identified by Breasted and Hall in Wadi 'Arah. Petrie identified it as 'Ar'arah, and his identification is the closest to the truth; since 'Ar'arah is very close to Tell 'Arah, it is the clear identity of the place" [translated from French, A.Z.].

In October 1972 a burial cave was discovered on the lower, southern, edge of the tell, and an emergency excavation was conducted (Siegelmann

1978). The tomb, which was cut into the soft chalky rock, was roundish in shape and was 2×2.5 m in size. The entrance was through a shaft, which was not excavated. About 15 burials were found. Inside the cave two stages were found: a later stage in which the bones were arranged on each side of the entrance, and the earlier stage, in which remains of skeletons were found in a pile near the entrance.

A relatively large ceramic assemblage was discovered in the cave. Among the locally-made vessels were 42 bowls, scattered all through the tomb; many of which were malformed: two cooking pots, three jars, of which two were decorated with stripes; 12 jugs with trifoliate rims; three decorated pilgrim flasks and ten oil lamps. Four Mycenaean vessels were also found, including a *pyxis* dating to Myc. IIIa, as well as a base ring, *bilbil* and milk bowls (Cypriot import). According to the finds, the site was dated to the first half of the 14th century BCE.

Two burial caves were excavated about 1 km west of Tell 'Arah in 1998-2000 (Gadot et al. 2009). The first cave was exposed with its entire contents, while the other one was robbed between the two excavation seasons.

The entrance to the first cave is by a shaft cut in the rock. In its lower part is a step leading into an arched passage linking the entrance to the main hall of the cave (about 3×2 m). On its three sides are five chambers, their entrances partially blocked by large jars. An opening in the floor of the south-eastern chamber leads into another burial cave, its floor about 0.5 m lower than that of the first cave. This cave is also cut as a shaft tomb, through which a central space (5×3 m) is reached. Three side chambers are accessible from this main space: one faces the entrance, with the other two on the eastern and western sides.

The finds in both caves amount to some 2000 ceramic vessels (most are local, and the rest imported from Lebanon, Cyprus and Greece), many scarabs (some bearing the names of Thutmose III and Amenhotep III), a cylinder seal, two tablet seals, a female clay figurine, an ivory pen-box, many bronze items (among them arrow heads, a dagger and brooches), beads and bone inlays. Among the burial gifts should be noted animal bones, mainly goats and sheep, collected in open bowls, and frog bones, sometimes headless, in the gift containers.

In light of the architectonic data and the distribution of finds in both caves, it seems that they were already cut during the Intermediate Bronze Age (despite the fact that no finds of this period were found in the cave). The other cave was in use in the Middle Bronze Age, and most of the finds of the period were found in it. The first cave was mainly in use in the Late

Bronze Age. The great number of jars found in the first cave prompted the excavators to assume that at some stage the cave became a store or a wine cellar.

A burial cave from the Roman and Byzantine periods was also excavated in the village (*Hadashot Arkheologiyot* 6; 7). To the front of the cave is a square courtyard, part of which was cut, and part built with ashlar. Ashlar steps led from the eastern side of the courtyard to the cave opening (1.5 m wide). At a later stage it was blocked by stones and a stone door was installed, found still on its hinge with the latch preserved. The vestibule height is about 2.7 m, and on its both sides were at least seven *loculi*. Stone sarcophagi were found in four of them (one of them, measuring 1.4×0.5×0.4 m, was exposed intact). The deceased buried in the cave were found not only in the *loculi* and sarcophagi, but also on the cave floor. The cave served for burials during the Roman period; and in the Byzantine period the *loculi* were emptied for new burials.

An Umayyad period residence house was excavated in 2007 on the southern slope of the tell (Massarwa 2010b). The ceramic finds included bowls, cooking kraters, cooking pots, jars, jugs, a juglet, and an oil lamp fragment. The glassware included a Roman bracelet and an Umayyad bottle.

A Moslem cemetery on the tell is also mentioned (Gadot 1999a: site 10; 2006: site 10; Gadot and Tepper 2009: site 227). The graves are located around a Sheikh's tomb, and remains of a quarry were found on the southern side of the site.

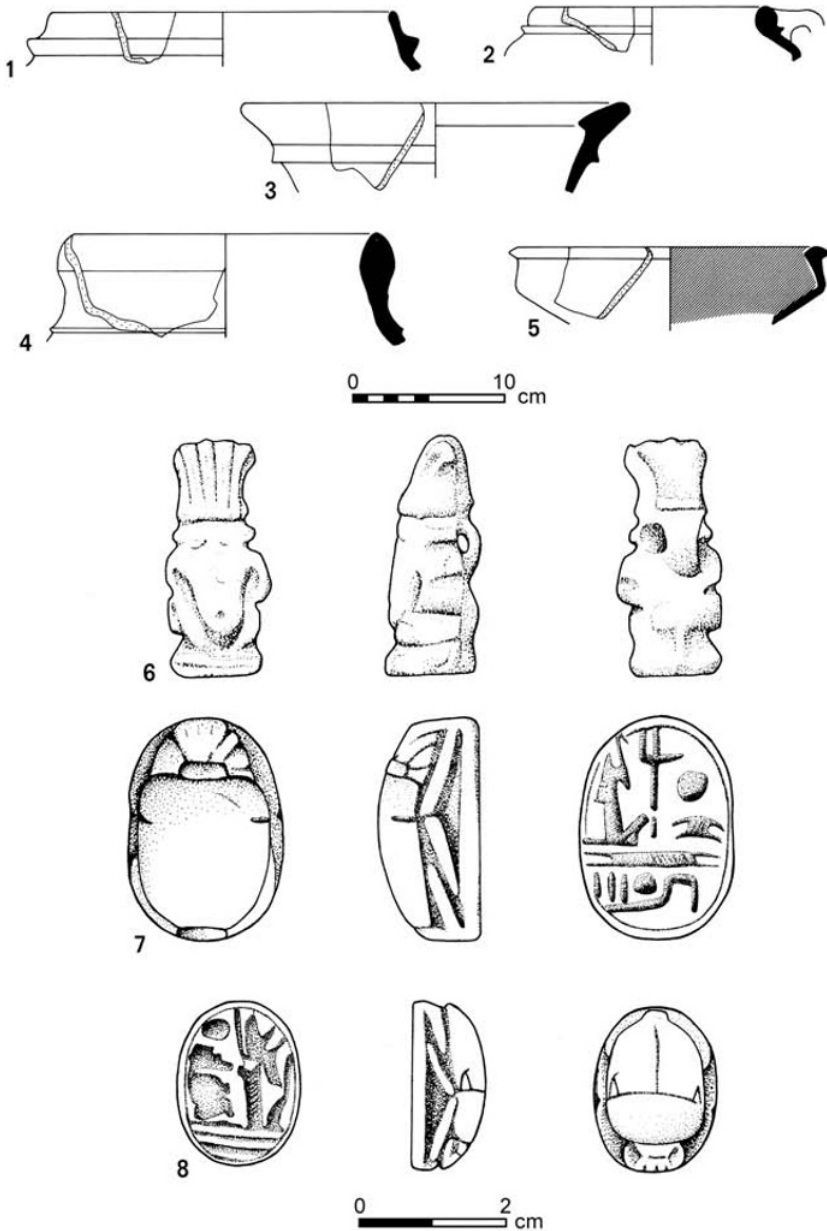
Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Middle Bronze IIb; Late Bronze I-II; Iron I; Iron II; Persian; Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

Identification: The site has been identified as 'Arunah, the place in the 'Iron Pass where Thutmosis III massed his army before going through the narrow pass to the battle at Megiddo during his first campaign (c. 1485 BCE). The name 'Arunah gave its name to the villages of 'Arah and 'Ar'arah and to Wadi 'Arah (Nahal 'Iron).

Noth's proposal of identifying the 'Arah of Joshua 13:4 as 'Arunah of the Egyptian sources' should also be considered; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: ANET: 235-236, 242; Kühner 1989: site 337; Goren et al. 2004: 346; Abu Hamid 2010; Massarwa 2010a.



39. Pottery and other finds from Tell 'Arah: 1.CP, IA Ic; 2.CP, brn, IA II; 3.Jar, yel, MB II; 4.Pithos, gr, IA I; 5.Bowl, rd slip, IA II; 6.Bes pendant, Faience; 7-8.Two scarabs of Ramses II from a tomb at 'Arah.

Site 14: 16-21/13/1

Khirbet Rabzeh

Israel grid: 1619 2133	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 6995 5996	Cultivation: olives
Elevation: 270 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 10
Name type: on map	Water source: 'Ein Da'ud (no. 151), 500 m distant
Site type: new houses on ruin	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), next to site
Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)	Visibility: 3
Topography: edge of ridge	Date of visit: Aug. 1993; 68 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: Terra rossa	

A family home on a small ruin at the top of a hill overlooking the 'Iron Pass to the north, about 2 km west of Umm el-Faḥm.

On the site are remains of a large family house from the Ottoman period, including a house and courtyard (25×30 m). The house and courtyard are built of stone plastered with loam and whitewashed. The original house has been preserved and in the courtyard are places for animals and a lavatory. Some of the cisterns are still in operation. The agricultural installations have also been preserved, including a threshing floor on a stone base.

It appears that the settlement was at its peak during the Ottoman period, when many families were leaving Umm el-Faḥm and began establishing small dwelling places in the area (e.g., Kh. el-'Arish).

Pottery: Byzantine – 2%; Middle Ages – 8%; Ottoman – 45%; Modern – 45%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 15: 16-21/43/1

Umm el-Faḥm

Israel grid: 1644 2136	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7020 5999	Cultivation: olives (partial)
Elevation: 450 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 100 (in ancient core)
Name type: ancient	Water source: 'Einot Umm el-Faḥm (8 wells), at site
Site type: town on several sites	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.5 km distant
Area: 50 dunams (5 ha) – the ancient core	Visibility: 6
Topography: saddle to west of Mt. Amir	Date of visit: 1989-1995, numerous visits and sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: Terra rossa	

A large city (50,000 inhabitants) on a high saddle in the western foothills of Mount Amir (Sheikh Iskander). From this saddle several water channels make their way westward, and the whole area has an abundance of springs.

The main springs are: 'Ein en-Nebi (on the way up to the town), 'Ein el-Bir (to the north), 'Ein Khaled and 'Ein Magharah (to the south-west). The ancient core is situated on the saddle to the west of Sheikh Iskander, and contains many stone houses from the Ottoman period, most of them deteriorating or in ruins. There are also many cisterns, quarried places, etc. On the north-western hill at the entrance to the village are burial caves from the Roman period.

The place is mentioned in Medieval sources as being in the Caesarea Crusader area, and was given in its entirety as an estate in the list of Baibars (March 1265 – Abel 1939: 41). The full proclamation was: "The Emir Jemal ed-Din en-Najibi, Sultan of Syria, [receives] all of Umm el-Faḥm from the territory of Caesarea" (Lyons 1971: 80). In the 1596 census it was in Shar'ah province and contained 24 Moslem taxpayers, who paid tax of 8,000 *aqia* for wheat and barley, 1,040 for summer crops and vegetables and 600 for olives (Hütteroth and 'Abdufattah 1977: 160). The village was fortified in 1774 as part of the preparations of Daher el-Omar and the residents of Mount Shechem for the revolt against Ottoman rule (Yekutieli 1971: 215).

According to a local tradition, the Jabbarin and Mahamid families, the most established families in the village, originated in Bet Jibrin (Meron and Kabha 1993: 60).

Robinson visited on 21 April 1852 and described: "Five minutes below the

top of the pass on the other side is the mouth of a lateral valley on the left, coming down nearly from the south. We entered and followed this up to its head in a pretty and well cultivated basin among the hills. On the steep declivity and ridge above it in the south-west, is situated the large village Um el-Fahm; to which we came at 12 o'clock. The ridge is narrow; and south of it a deep valley runs out to the western plain. The side valley which we had ascended, is likewise separated from the valley we left only by a ridge; on the southern end of this latter is the village. It thus overlooks the whole country towards the west; with a fine prospect of the plain and sea, and also of Carmel; with glimpses of the Plain of Esdraelon, and a view of Tabor and Little Hermon beyond. There was, however, a haze in the atmosphere, which prevented us from distinguishing the villages in the plain.

There were said to be in Um el-Fahm twenty or thirty families of Christians; some said more. Outside of the village, near the western brow, was a cemetery. Here too was a threshing-sledge; in form like the stone-sledge of New England; made of three planks, each a foot wide; with holes thickly bored in the bottom, into which were driven projecting bits of black volcanic stone. The village belongs to the government of Jenin. They had hitherto paid their taxes at so much a head; but the governor had recently taken an



40. A stone structure, about 2 km south-east of Umm el-Fahm, 1992.

account of their land, horses, and stock; with the purpose, as was supposed, of exacting the tithe. Twenty-five men had been taken as soldiers under the conscription.

Having obtained a guide with some difficulty, we left Um el-Fahm for Ya'bud, at 1 o'clock, after passing through the whole length of the village. It was our general purpose, to keep along on the western part of the hills of Samaria, either above or below the brow, as the case might be; and holding ourselves ready to turn aside to any place, to which a visit might seem desirable..." (Robinson 1970, III: 119–120).

In 1853 Rabbi Ya'acob Sapir Halevy visited the village and wrote: "It is the joyful city of Umm el Fahm and its subsidiary towns, where I have gone several times to pick citrus fruit... which grows profusely there. This large city stands at the top of a high, steep mountain, and its inhabitants, Ishmaelites, merchants and Muhamadites, a few thousand homeowners, and a very few Christians, but no Jews, only those who come to trade there from Haifa and Shefaram and 'Acco, for there is no police force or governor, only a village elder on every street... and it has a few commercial shops, for almost all of the inhabitants are felahim, field workers. And their houses are full of good things, silver and gold and delicacies, for they have many flocks of sheep, goats and cattle, and the best stallions that can be found, and countless camels and donkeys. Around the city are big valleys, springs, fields,



41. Umm el-Fahm, general view looking north-east, 1999. On the summit to the right is Sheikh Iskander. Photo: M. Weinberg.

gardens, orchards and grazing lands far from the city. On three of its sides it is surrounded by the largest forests in the Land of Israel and there are places where one can walk for several hours in the dark under cover of trees." (Vilnay 1960: 50-51).

Guérin (1969b: 239) did not visit the spot, but he passed it by. He wrote: "A large village on a high hill by the name of Umm el-Faḥm. Its construction is poor, and it was improperly built on the site of an ancient village whose name is unknown, the new name of which, Umm el Faḥm ('mother of charcoal') is obviously Arabic. It contains several supposedly ancient cisterns. It has about 1800 residents. They raise, in the shadow of the hill at whose peak their houses stand, handsome orchards which are watered by the springs and in which they grow figs, lemons, pomegranates and olives." [translated from French, A.Z.].

In the British Survey is the following description: "Umm el Fahm – Next to Jenin this is the most important place on the Sheet, although a modern village. The village is divided into four quarters..."[see Drake's description that follows]. "...There are some 80 Christians, and the total population would probably amount to some 500 souls... The village is well built of stone, standing on a sort of saddle, with four springs on the north-east. The Mukam of Sheikh Iskander is on the hill above. The camp [of the Survey] was established in 1872 in the low ground, near the principal spring, 'Ain el Bir" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46).

This is the description of Tyrwhitt-Drake of the British Survey:

"The village beside which we are now camped is a large one, and divided into four quarters, El Jebarin, El Mahamin, El Maj'ahineh, and El Akbar'iyeh, each of which has its own sheikh. There are some fifteen houses of Christians, which represent a total of about eighty souls. These are mostly birds of passage, who 'squat' wherever and as long as, they find it convenient, and then flit 'to fresh fields and pastures new'. The natives are an unruly lot, who never paid taxes till within the last few years, and who have not yet learnt the lesson of subjection. Some days ago a man tried to seize my horse's bridle as I was passing near a threshing-floor, and insolently told me to be off, at the same time making as though he would strike me; but, seeing then that he had gone rather too far, took to his heels and fled. After a suspense of three or four days, I consented, at the intercession of two of the sheikhs, the kadi, and other village worthies, not to have the man imprisoned at Jen'in [sic], so he was brought and solemnly beaten before my tent door by the sheikh of his quarter. As civility in this country is induced by fear and a sense of inferiority, we shall probably be treated with decent respect for some little

time to come. One cause of the villagers' unruliness is their wealth: they possess large herds of cattle and flocks of goats, a very considerable number of horses, and more than the normal quantity of camels and donkeys. Their land comprises a wide tract of thicket (called Umm el Khattaf, 'Mother of the Ravisher,' from the dense growth which, as it were, seizes and holds those who try to pass through it) to the south and east, arable hills to the west, and virtually as much of the rich plain of Esdraelon (Merj ibn 'Amir) as they choose to cultivate. Besides all this, the village owns some twenty or more springs, under whose immediate influence orange and lemon trees flourish. Shaddocks [citrus fruit] grow to an enormous size; I have one now in the tent whose circumference lengthwise is 2ft. 6½ in, and its girth 2ft. 3½ in; weight, about eight or nine pounds; and tomatoes, cucumbers, and other thirsty vegetables flourish. The taxes paid by the village amount to 23,000 piasters, or £185 sterling, in addition to the poll-tax on sheep, goats, and cattle, which probably comes to £20 or more." (Tyrwhitt-Drake 1873: 28–29).

According to Meron and Kabha (1993: 39 ff.) the villagers began paying taxes only at the end of the 18th century, in the time of Ahmed Jazzar Basha, the governor of Acco (1720–1804). Previously they had refused to pay, and then a miracle occurred, associated with the name of Sheikh Abed el-Khaleq, whose tomb now stands in the centre of the village. As a result of the miracle the village was not destroyed. Among the local Christians are traditions of a man of renown by the name of Habib (Meron and Kabha 1993: 47–48).

In and around the village there are a good many local traditions connected with Abraham the Patriarch. According to these traditions, Abraham visited Umm el-Faḥm during his wanderings and settled there for some time. This tradition is attested to by local place names: in the village is Bir Khalil, 'Ein Khalil, [the Arabic name for Abraham], 'Ein Ibrahim (next to the Wadi 'Arah road) and 'Ein en-Nabi ['spring of the prophet'].

Gadot (1999a: sites 25–26; 1999b; 2006: sites 25–26) surveyed two hilltops in the town: Khirbet el-Batin (Israel grid 1645/2144) where he noted a ruin now almost totally covered by the town houses with stone heaps and walls remains and Iron Age II sherds; and Khirbet Jarrar (Israel grid 1637/2130) where Persian and Roman sherds were collected.

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys): Iron II; Persian; Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages; Ottoman.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Beyer 1936: 10, 52, 54.

Site 16: 16-21/53/1

Esh-Sheikh Iskander

Israel grid: 1656 2132
 UTM grid: 7032 5995
 Elevation: 527 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.
 Name type: appears on map as
 ancient
 Site type: sheikh's tomb
 Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)
 Topography: high summit
 Rock type: Judah group
 Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 4
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: 1
 Water source: 'Ein Iskander (no. 8),
 at site
 Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 1.2 km
 distant
 Visibility: 8
 Date of visit: Dec. 1992; 15 sherds

A sheikh's tomb on the highest summit in the Nahal 'Iron area (E.P. 527), on the eastern side of the town of Umm el-Faḥm.

The tomb (now restored) is in a modern neighbourhood, near the modern water reservoir, private homes and Museum of Islam. The structure is in the western part of the large summit of Sheikh Iskander, and includes the tomb of the sheikh itself – a building consisting of a room and entranceway, 6×10 m, and a courtyard surrounding it. The whole structure is recent, but is built on top of an earlier one. There is also some secondary use of ancient stones. In the room are the tomb itself and a *mihrab* (Islamic prayer niche) and niches for oil lamps. Around the building were found, after considerable searching, a few Ottoman sherds, which may indicate the time it was established. No earlier sherds were found, and possibly the ancient site was destroyed in building the new one.

In the British Survey journal of October 1872 Tyrwhitt-Drake wrote:

"The tomb of Weli Iskander, which stands near here, has proved a most valuable trigonometrical station. This personage is, on the authority of the Kadi, one of the kings of the Children of Israel, but I cannot find any foundation for this legend in history, unless it be some memory of Alexander, son of Herod, who was strangled at Sebaste, but buried at Alexandrium (Jos. B. J. 1 xxvii. 6). Others say that it is a makam in honour of Alexander the Great, of whom Moslem legends, with their usual disregard for chronology, tell marvellous tales. He was a negro, the son of El Dhab'aak, king of Himyar, and a Greek princess, and is called Iskander z'ul Karnayn, "Alexander with the two horns," which grew like a ram's from his temples. To conceal them he invented the turban; he also invented the fashion of shaking hands. He

had an interview with Abraham in Wadi Seb'a (Beersheba) B.C. 300; his conquests extended over the world, and amongst other notables he slew Yajuj and Majuj (Gog and Magog), who were each 240 feet high; and to avoid the plague which would ensue from the putrefaction of such a mass of flesh, he caused an army of birds of prey to tear off their flesh and carry it to the sea. These giants were omnivorous; they ate trees, crops, men, horses, and cattle, and were able to drink the Lake of Tiberias dry in a single day. Some of their race, who were also cannibals, rode ants as large as camels instead of horses. Alexander was a fit hero to cope with such monsters, as his nose was three spans long and, of course, the rest of his body in proportion. Og, the king of Bashan, to reach whose knee Moses, who was twenty cubits high, took an axe twenty cubits long and leapt up twenty cubits from the earth, must doubtless have been a connection of these giants.

In several places among the brushwood we have observed square towers measuring twelve to fifteen feet on each side, and built of roughly-hewn stones two to four feet long. These, together with huge built-up cairns, and the rock-hewn wine and oil presses, are doubtless of remote antiquity." (Tyrwhitt-Drake 1873: 30-31).

Pottery: Ottoman – 80%; Modern – 20%.

Previous surveys: None.



42. Structure of Sheikh Iskander's tomb. From left: Z. Horowitz, K. Rafael, S. Hashman, N. Mirkam, 1992. Photo: A. Zertal.

Site 17: 16-21/73/1

Khirbet eṭ-Ṭaiybeh

Israel grid: 1671 2137	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7047 6001	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 340 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 30
Name type: ancient	Water source: 'Ein Zeituneh (no. 139), 2 km distant
Site type: village on ruin	Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 2 km distant
Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m) – ancient core	Visibility: 4
Topography: slope	Date of visit: Dec. 1992; 40 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A village extending over the southern slope of the hill of Khirbet eṭ-Ṭaiybeh and the narrow ravine south of it. It is located in a region of low hills, about 2 km east of Umm el-Faḥm.

The ancient core is especially small. Today the village covers the slopes surrounding it, and it is connected by good roads to Rummaneh, Umm el-Faḥm and 'Anin.

The village is not mentioned in the Medieval sources. In the Ottoman census of 1596 it appears as Tayyiba, but it is unclear whether this is the Khirbet eṭ-Ṭaiybeh dealt with here. It had six Moslem taxpayers, and the total tax they paid was 3500 *aqia*. Of this, 2500 for wheat and barley and the rest was for olives and other produce (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 160).

The British Survey describes it as: "Et Taiyibeh – A modern ruined village with springs." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 68).

A salvage excavation took place at the site headed by Abd el-Latif Qad-dumi (Greenberg and Keinan 2009: site 4). It was mainly active in the Late Roman, Byzantine, and Medieval periods. Other periods were Persian, Early Moslem and Ottoman. There is no further information.

Pottery: Persian – 10%; Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 25%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 20%; Ottoman – 5%.

Identification: Gal (1980: 96) proposed identifying the place as 'Ophrah of Abiezer, the town from which Gideon of the tribe of Manasseh came (Judges 6:24). This suggestion is based on "the ceramic find that the survey came up with, which included Israelite pottery", but it is unclear which sur-

vey is being referred to. For a discussion on the identification, see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Vilnay 1968: 166; Dauphin 1998 III: site 51.



Site 18: 16-21/12/1

Khirbet 'Ein el-Mu'allaqah

Israel grid: 1619 2123	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 6995 5985	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 230 m a.s.l., 80 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: on map, but not as historic site	Water source: 'Ein Mu'allaqah (no. 143), at site
Site type: fortress	Road: Mu'allaqah–Jenin (C17), at site
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Visibility: 1
Topography: narrow ravine	Date of visit: June 1997; 20 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

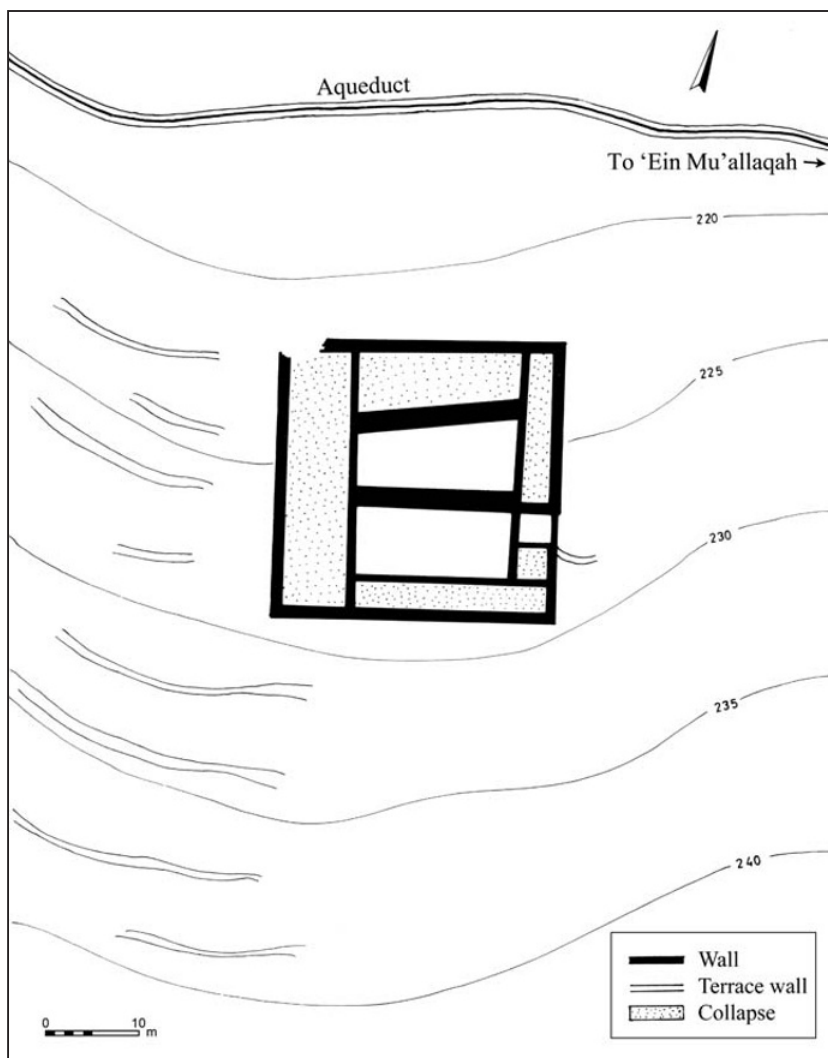
A well-built fortress in a narrow ravine near 'Ein el-Mu'allaqah spring, next to the place where Wadi Sheri'ah and Wadi Mu'allaqah meet, about 2 km west of Mei-'Ami.

On the southern bank of Wadi Sheri'ah and Wadi Mu'allaqah a courtyard-fortress built of large slightly cut stones was investigated. The square fortress is 32×32 m, and has a central courtyard whose original dimensions were approximately 20×20 m. Partially surrounding the central courtyard are three parallel wings, apparently separated into rooms by dividing walls. It can be assumed that such a wing also had a northern side, but the corresponding wall was not found. Two walls 2.2m wide cross the centre of the courtyard from west to east. These may very well represent a later stage of use of the fortress. The walls are 1.2 m thick, and are built of two rows of large stones. In the southern (upper) part the walls are 1.5–2 m high, while the north-western corner was destroyed by bulldozing. One of the rooms in the eastern wing was excavated by local residents, and they related, "someone from Umm el-Faḥm lived there 40 years ago".

Above the wadi channel and under the fortress an apparently modern

built aqueduct was found, which distributed spring water among the agricultural plots. Close to the fortress on the west is a narrow channel that carried water from the southern slopes into the wadi. The fountainhead of the spring ('Ein Mu'allaqah) is now closed off, and the rest of its water flows through a pipe.

Apparently there was a Roman road in this area that ascended to 'Ein



43. Plan of the Roman fortress at Khirbet Mu'allaqah. Note the aqueduct, still in use, 1997.

Sheri'ah and to the large site at the Qaṣr Sheri'ah.

The site does not appear on the British Survey map, nor in the survey's book, nor in other sources. The wadi is labelled Wadi el-Ariyan on the British map, and 'Ein el-Mu'allaqah does not appear there at all. On the British Survey map the site appears in the place of Sheri'ah, while its definition fits Mu'allaqah. According to the British Survey, there are remnants of a structure near a well and a good spring (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 64). It seems that there was confusion between Qaṣr Sheri'ah and the fortress at Mu'allaqah.

Rabbi Ya'acob Sapir Halevy visited the spot in 1853 and described it in his book, *Even Sapir*: "Further on from there [from 'Ein Jarrar, A.Z.] between the forests is a dear place with springs, gardens and orchards called Mu'allaqah. Further on from there, in the wood, a half hour's walk to the biggest place of all, a few springs, many gardens and orchards is a place called Wad el-Qaseb. I walked in these places, drank the water and blessed and ate the fruit. Aside from these there are many other places like these, some inhabited, and they should not be passed by without bow and arrows due to mortal danger." (Vilnay 1960: 51).

Pottery: Late Roman (in the wadi beneath the fortress) – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

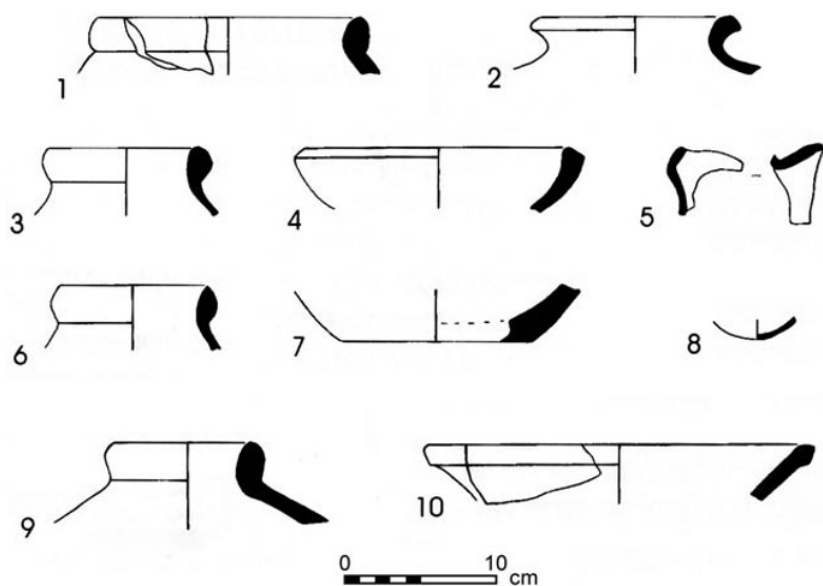


Site 19: 16-21/32/1

Khirbet Muwanis

Israel grid: 1636 2123	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7013 5985	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 440 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: on map as ancient site	Water source: 'Einot Sheri'ah
Site type: small ruin	(no. 14), 1 km distant
Area: 2.5 dunams (2500 sq. m)	Road: Mu'allaqah–Jenin (C17),
Topography: mountainous saddle	1.2 km distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 8
Soil type: terra rossa	Date of visit: Nov. 1992; 29 sherds

A small site on a high saddle, just south of the Mei-'Ami – Nahal 'Iron road, about 400 m west of Mei-'Ami. South of it the area of Wadi Sheri'ah



44. Pottery from Kh. Muwanis, all Pers: 1-3, 6, 9. Jars, gr and yel; 4, 7, 10. Bowls, gr; 5. Jug handle; 8. Small jar base, yel.



45. The site of Kh. Muwanis, looking west. In the wood is the tomb of Sheikh et-Telluli, 1992. Photo: A. Zertal.

descends, and on this slope is the agricultural area of Mei-'Ami.

Scattered on the saddle are stones arranged as long straight walls. The stones are small field stones, but here and there are foundations and corners of walls made of cut stones. In the centre of the site is an open courtyard, with walls, possibly the remains of rooms, surrounding it.

The site appears to be a farm from the Persian period, which has been completely dismantled. Foundation remains, covered with piles of field stones, probably come from the clearing of the fields. Somewhat to the west of the ruin is the tomb of Sheikh et-Telluli, which is also indicated on the British Survey map.

Iron Age II and Roman sherds were also found during the Wadi 'Arah survey in the vicinity of the site (Gadot 1999a: site 24; 1999b; 2006: site 24), mainly in the cultivation terraces over the eastern slope towards the road to Mei-'Ami.

Pottery (in our survey): Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 20: 16-21/52/1

'Anin

Israel grid: 1659 2120	rossa
UTM grid: 7035 5983	Soil quality: 7
Elevation: 405 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name type: ancient	Cisterns: about 40 (in ancient core)
Site type: Arab village on tell	Water source: 'Ein Zeituneh
Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha) –	(no. 139), at site
ancient core	Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), at site
Topography: high slope	Visibility: 8
Rock type: Judah group	Date of visit: Jan.-Feb. 1998;
Soil type: brown forest and terra	85 sherds

A small village on a tell at the edge of a ridge, on the high southern slope of Mount Amir (Sheikh Iskander), overlooking the deep Nahal Zavdon and the Jezreel Valley.

Nearby are six springs ('Ein Zeituneh, 'Ein Qamar, 'Ein ez-Zureiq, 'Ein Umm ed-Duyuq, 'Ein Kharrubeh and 'Ein Fadi'ah). The road from Ya'bad to



46. Bird's eye view of the village of 'Anin, looking east. The ancient tell is on the ridge on the right. In the background is Wadi Tabaj beneath the tell.

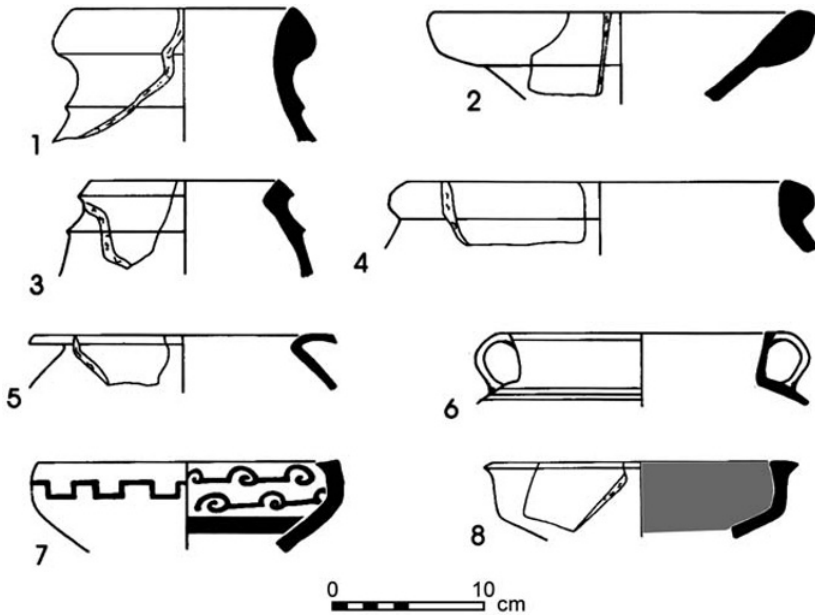
Photo: M. Weinberg, 1998.

the village of Ti'inik passes through it.

The ancient core of the village is located at the edge of the ridge south of the present road and near the mosque. Steep slopes descend from it to the west, south and east. On the high part of the western slope is an enclosure wall built of large stones, perhaps the original fortification of the tell. Above it there are many remains of buildings from the Ottoman period and perhaps also from the Middle Ages, mainly semi-ruined arched structures. In the lower part of the tell, in the south-west, is a spring, 'Ein Umm ed-Duyuq. In the eastern part are other springs, 'Ein Qamar and 'Ein Zureiq. According to the residents, one can descend by steps and a rock-cut tunnel at 'Ein Zureiq (this was not investigated), where there are man-made pools. In the eastern part of the village is the tomb of Sheikh Radwan.

On the hill to the west of the village was the tomb of Sheikh Naser, which was destroyed by bulldozing. According to the residents there was a carved inscription next to 'Ein Kharrubeh, which was sawn off the rock in about 1970. There is a tradition of a monastery at the site, called Dir 'Anin.

Iron Age and Persian pottery was found mainly on the south-eastern



47. Pottery from 'Anin: 1.Pithos, gr, IA I; 2.Bowl, Pers, gr; 3.Jar, brn, IA II; 4.Krater, brn, IA I; 5.Bowl, brn, Rom; 6.CP, brn, Rom; 7.Bowl, brn on wh dec, MA; 8.Bowl, rd slip, IA II.

slope. Later pottery (Roman onwards) was found on the upper, western, slope.

In 1596 there were 16 Moslem taxpayers in the village. The village paid tax of a quarter of its crops, totalling 3600 *aqia*. Of this, wheat and barley accounted for 2200 *aqia* and olives for 360 (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159).

The British Survey describes: "a small village on a ridge, partly built of stone, with a small olive grove beneath it on the west, and two wells on that side. It has the appearance of an ancient site, having rock-cut tombs, and a curious channel for water." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 44). In the archaeological chapter the waterworks are described as follows: "Immediately north of the village is a rock-cut passage large enough to walk along, extending about 50 feet and lined with cement; it then becomes about a foot high. This leads out on to a flat surface of rock. It may have some connection with the Lavacra of Jerome. (...) Two rock-cut tombs, now blocked, exist west of this." (Idem: 51). The village is not mentioned in Vilnay's book on Judea and Samaria (Vilnay 1968).

A tell (apparently fortified) existed here during the Iron Age. There was a medium-sized settlement during the Persian period; following an interval during the Hellenistic period, apparently linked with the general decrease in settlement during this time. The settlement here was renewed during the Early Roman period, and from then on has been continuous until this day.

Pottery: Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 15%; Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 5%; Ottoman – 10%.

Identification: it has been proposed that the place is connected with Ani'am, one of the sons of Shemida of the Manasseh families (I Chron. 7:19). This identification is based on the location, period and possible linguistic association. It has also been proposed that this may be Janua of the Onomasticon (no. 544), three Roman miles south of Legio; or 'Ananin, a town in the list of permitted towns from the synagogue of Rehov; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998 III: site 69.



Site 21: 15-21/80/1

Khirbet 'Ein Umm es-Samal

Israel grid: 1582 2108	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 6959 5969	Cultivation: orchards
Elevation: 200 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest settlement	Water source: 'Ein Umm es-Samal
Site type: medium-sized	(no. 138), at site
Area: 6 dunams (6000 sq. m)	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.2 km
Topography: slope	distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 4
Soil type: terra rossa	Date of visit: Dec. 1997; 71 sherds

A medium-sized site on a high slope, slightly south of 'Ein Umm es-Samal and on the western fringe of the village of 'Ar'arah.

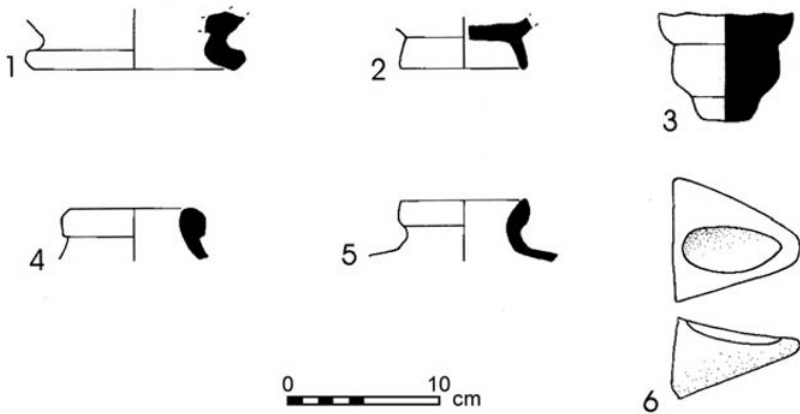
The waters from the spring ('Ein Umm es-Samal) are today collected into a cement pool. Its location (and that of the site) is slightly outside of

'Ar'arah to the west, close to an unpaved road that exits from the road to Qatzir and enters the village. Today the road passes above the ancient site. Above it, in an olive grove, a considerable sherd scatter was found, as well as a few building stones. The site extends, around and above the spring, over an area of about 6 dunams (6000 sq. m). It appears that its buildings were destroyed when the olive groves were planted, or beforehand. A farm or small village once stood here.

In the Wadi 'Arah survey, later than ours, the site is marked to be in way-point 1579/2108 (Gadot 1999a: site 9; 2006: site 9; Gadot and Tepper 2009: site 313), and its area is estimated to be 10 dunams (1 ha).

Pottery: Persian – 20%; Hellenistic – 20%; Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 35%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.



48. Pottery from 'Ein Umm es-Samal: 1. Mortaria, yel, Pers; 2. Bowl, yel, MA; 3. Jar base, Hel; 4-5. Jars, gr, Pers-Hel; 6. Lamp rim, Herodian (not to scale).

Site 22: 15-21/91/1

Khirbet 'Ein el-Balad ('Ar'arah)

Israel grid: 1593 2111	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 6970 5972	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 240 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 15
Name type: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein el-Balad (no. 18), at site
Site type: ancient core of Arab village	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.2 km distant
Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)	Visibility: 5
Topography: slope	Repeated visits 1995-1997; 50 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: rendzina	

This is the ancient core of the large village of 'Ar'arah, located on the slope, and a centre of the modern village, about 1 km south of the ancient road from the Sharon region to the Jezreel Valley.

About 300 m south-east of the spring ('Ein el-Balad), seen today in the form of a pool with concrete sides, are the remnants of a structure with a courtyard from the Ottoman period. This includes the southern half of the structure, containing three large rooms with arched entranceways. In the area of the structure there are two built cisterns. Close to the road descending to the north-west toward the exit from the village, and south of it, is a row of rock-cut burial caves. The cave openings, apparently cut during the Roman period, are arched; the entrance inside was through a square opening. All the other ruins have long since disappeared, but the place of the spring around which the village developed is discernable.

According to various sources of information, the location was a fortress or a Crusader estate, known as *Castellum Arearum*; but it is unclear whether this was in fact in 'Arah or 'Ar'arah. In March 1265 Baibars awarded the estate at this site to the Emirs who had participated in the victory over the Crusaders in these words: "To Emir Alla ed-Din, brother of the Duweidar, half of 'Ar'arah; to the Emir Seif ed-Din el-Baghdadi, half of 'Ar'arah" (Lyons 1971: 80). According to Maqrizi, Baibars stopped in the valley of 'Arah and 'Ar'arah during his campaign to conquer Caesarea (663 according to the *Hajrah*, 1264 CE).

In the Ottoman census of 1596 the village was in the Shar'ah province, and had eight single Moslem men. The village paid 5160 *aqia* for wheat and barley and 2000 *aqia* for olives (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159).

In the British Survey the place is described as: “‘Ararah – A village of moderate size on high ground, with a spring to the east, a second to the west, and a well to the south. There are rock-cut tombs nearby. The population is stated by Consul Rogers (1859) at 400, the cultivation being then 30 feddans.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 41).

In 1975 a salvage excavation was carried out in a burial cave within the village confines (Zias 1980). The cave, cut in chalky rock, includes a central vestibule with four crypts cut into its walls. The vestibule contained a pit around which were cut three stone benches. Five prismatic limestone coffins, some mounted on four legs with a gabled lid, were discovered. The coffin walls are decorated with square reliefs, and some have concentric circles on them. The find was dated to the end of the 1st–2nd century CE.

In 1994 another cave was excavated (Israel grid 1590/2100; Lipkowsky 2008). The cave was cut into chalky rock, and was used for burial during two periods – Late Roman (3rd–5th centuries CE) and Mamluk (12th–13th centuries CE). The ancient stage included a courtyard that was partly preserved, and a burial vestibule with a burial stone rolled across the entrance. From the courtyard a corridor led to a staircase descending into a burial chamber (3.5×3.5 m), in three of whose walls are cut identical burial basins. A thin layer of ash sealing the ancient stage and traces of soot on the cave walls are evidence of a conflagration. In the later stage another opening was cut above the original one, which was blocked. On the silt layer, filling the cave since its use in the Roman period, were found many skeletons dating to the Mamluk period.

Another burial cave, about 100 m north of the former, was explored by Massarwa (2011). The cave was cut into chalky rock, and only its southern part, which includes three crypts and finds dated to the Roman-Byzantine period, has been preserved.

Salvage excavations were conducted from 2006 to 2011 in ancient Ar'arah. The main findings from these archaeological activities are:

1. In the eastern margins of El-Aḥwat (site 28 in this volume, Israel grid 1591/2102) an agricultural area was traced, which includes terraces, structures and watchtowers, dated to the Roman period, 2nd–3rd centuries CE (Gorzalczany et al. 2009).
2. At the lower part of the western hill of the settlement Qatzir (Israel grid 1594/2104) were found remnants of a farm (?) and various agricultural elements (Massarwa 2011). The remains include three structures and a watchtower dated to the Roman period.
3. Remains of structures, a watchtower and a field tower from the Roman

period, at the lower part of the western hill of the Qatzir settlement (Israel grid 1591/2101 - Massarwa 2013). A rectangular structure, 16×13 m, its central courtyard and five small rooms around it, were excavated. Close to the structure are scant remnants of another structure, a square watchtower, 10×10 m, and a rectangular field tower, 5×4.5 m, 1.3 m preserved height.

In the outskirts of the village Gadot and Tepper (2009: sites 269-271) surveyed burial caves and agricultural installations with Roman-Byzantine sherds (Israel grid 1587/2117), and stone heaps, agricultural installations and caves (Israel grid 1587/2111), with sherds dated to the Persian, Byzantine and Early Moslem periods.

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Persian; Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages; Ottoman; Modern.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Beyer 1936: 35-36; Kühner 1989: sites 346-347; Dauphin 1998, III: site 62; Jackson-Tal 2008.



Site 23: 16-21/11/1

‘Ein eṣ-Şaleḥ

Israel grid: 1618 2111

UTM grid: 6995 5973

Elevation: 160 m a.s.l., 70 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric and sherd scatter

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: narrow ravine

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: alluvial

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: ‘Ein eṣ-Şaleḥ
(no. 153), at site

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km
distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: Dec. 1997; 70 flint tools
and 15 sherds

A sherd and flint tool scatter on the southern rim of Wadi Qaşab, close to ‘Ein eṣ-Şaleḥ.

Wadi Qaşab is the continuation of Wadi Mu‘allaqah, continuing into the ‘Arunah Valley. Close to the entrance to the valley are three springs: Bir

Taiyuneh, 'Ein eṣ-Ṣaleḥ and 'Ein Qubu. Near to 'Ein eṣ-Ṣaleḥ, which today is contained in a concrete pool, a scatter of flint tools and a few sherds were found. Apparently the place was a prehistoric site that was sparsely inhabited during the historic period. Due to rapid construction, it was not possible to discover the historic site, but it was apparently in the ascent of the southern bank of the wadi.

About 70 flint items were collected, including non-retouched bladelets and bladelet cores. Various types of flint sources were clearly used. A basalt pestle and a basalt axe head were also collected. The site is dated to the Epi-Palaeolithic, but it is difficult to determine the exact sub-period. According to A. Ronen (pers. comm.), it is close to the Kebarrian period, but also contains material from the Neolithic period.

Flint tools: Epi-Paleolithic – Neolithic

Pottery: Persian – 50%; Hellenistic – 50%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 24: 16-21/31/1

Qaṣr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah (on British Survey map: Kusr 'Ain esh-Sheriah)

Israel grid: 1632 2115

UTM grid: 7008 5977

Elevation: 350 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic place

Site type: tell and large ruin

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 4

Water source: 'Einot Sheri'ah

(no. 14), 400 m distant

Road: Mu'allaqah–Jenin (C17),

at site

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Nov. 1992 and many

other visits; 242 sherds

A tell and large ruin on the fairly steep, northern slope of the Sheri'ah range, in the area south of Nahal 'Iron and about 1.2 km south-west of Mei-'Ami.

The tell is located on a slope within a wood of pine trees. Unpaved roads connect it with Mei-'Ami, and to the Mei-'Ami–Nahal 'Iron road, and 'Ein Mu'allaqah. A wadi of the same name goes north to Sheri'ah Springs close

by, and from there it leads off into a pleasant canyon in the direction of 'Ein Mu'allaqah.

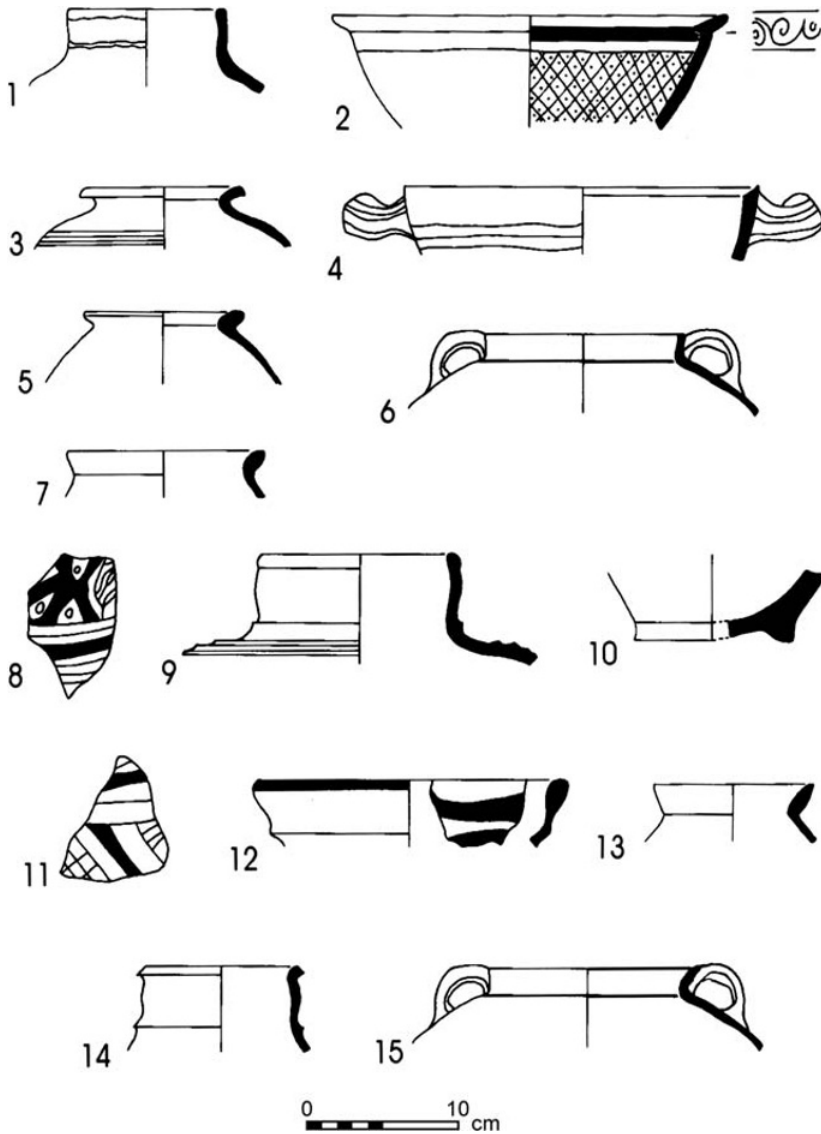
The site extends over three to five high artificial terraces, whose general direction is east-west, and which descend to the north. On each of these steps are multi-roomed structures, running parallel to the terraces. Most of the construction in the entire site is of large dressed stones and some ashlars.

In the centre is a large structure, the outer corners of which have been preserved. It is 25×40 m and is built of Herodian-style drafted-border ash-lars. Similar drafting is noticeable on other large stones at the upper part of the site. Below this 'Herodian' structure is a high step, and next to it to the east is another building, 10×25 m, of large stones, in a good state of preservation. The entrance is on the north side, where one lintel is preserved *in situ*. It is especially well built, and resembles a fortress. Among the high terraces, roads, passageways, and streets can be discerned, and a similar street also seals the western side.

Near the banks of Wadi Sheri'ah, which flows from the west below the site, several burial caves were discovered. Around the entrance of one of them is an engraved decoration, surrounding the opening in the form of



49. Corner of public structure at Qaşr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah. Note the drafted margins of the ash-lars. In photo: K. Raphael. Photo: A. Zertal. 1992.

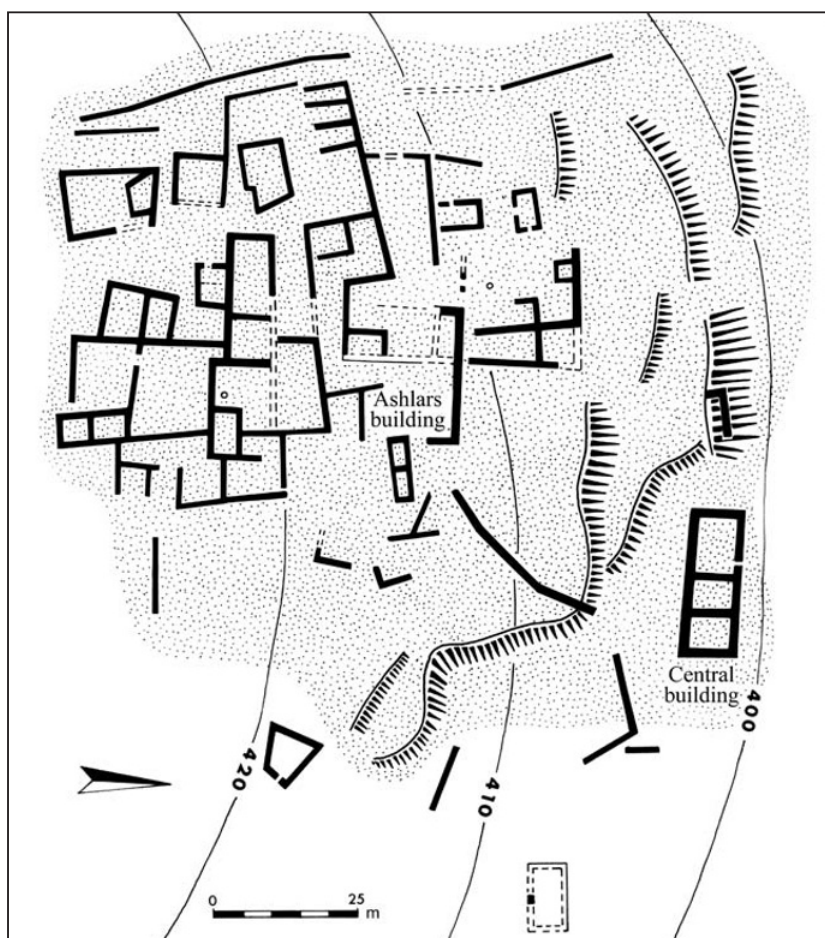


50. Pottery from Qaşr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah: 1.Jar, yel, Rom; 2.Bowl, brn on wh, MA; 3.Jar, gr, ER; 4.'Frying pan', brn, Byz; 5-6.CP, brn, ER; 7.Jug, yel, Hel; 8, 11.Dec sherd, blk and rd on wh, MA (Mam); 9.Jar, gr, LR; 10.Jug base, brn, IA I-II; 12.Dec bowl, MA; 13.Jug, lt, Hel; 14.Jar, brn, Byz; 15.CP, ER.

an arch. The decoration is in three strips or registers: the lowest one has a complex geometric design, the one above it has an egg-and-dart relief, and the upper one bears the design of an *Acanthus syriacus*. The entrances to the other burial caves are also arched, but lack decoration.

This is an important and impressive site, which apparently fulfilled some role in guarding the springs and, possibly, in guarding the road. The high quality of the construction of this Roman site is unusual in this provincial area. The historical continuity can possibly be explained by its proximity to the water source.

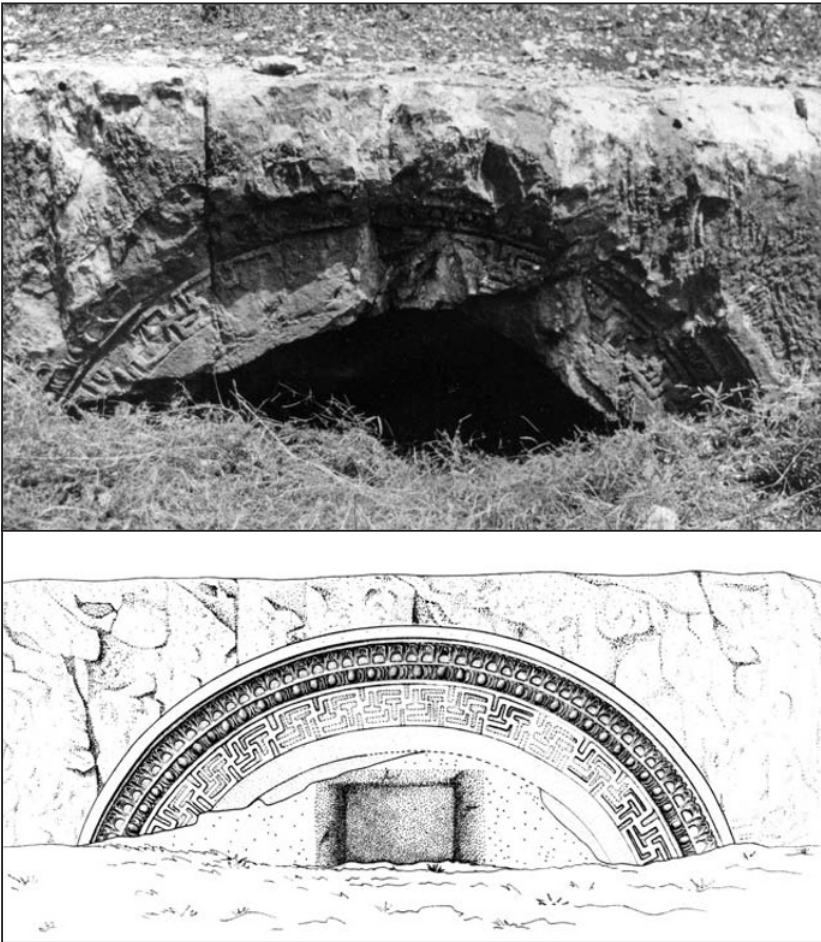
In the British Survey, the site is described as ruins of a structure with



51. Plan of Qaṣr 'Ein esh-Sheri'ah, 1994.

a well close to a good spring (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 64). This description does not fit the present site, and apparently was erroneously transferred to the structure at 'Ein Mu'allaqah (Site 18).

In 1878 Yoel Moshe Salomon visited the Sheri'ah region, as part of a group of Jews from Jerusalem who were journeying through Nahal 'Iron in order to procure etrogs (a citrus fruit required for Succoth rituals). Here is his description: "And we hastened to take the road from there (Barta'ah) to the garden of Shara'iyah. This road, also, passes through the forest. And with great effort we came to the above garden at three p.m. The garden of



52. Above: the decorated archway to the Roman period burial cave. Photo – S. Hashman. Below: recreation of the decorated archway by S. Haad. 1998.

Shara'iyah stands at the descent from a fine mountain, and a garden spring watered the plants of the orchard. Its trees are fresh and full of very large citrus fruit. And everyone noted that they were majestic, glorious fruits of the land" (Vilnay 1960: 52).

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 4%; Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 8%; Hellenistic – 16%; Early Roman – 37%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 5%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Identification: It is proposed to identify this place as Bet Hinnai (Bet Yanai?) of the Onomasticon, the bathing place 20 miles east of Caesarea. Qaṣr Sheri'ah seems to us to fit this identification better than Kfar 'Anin; see fuller discussion and bibliography in Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 23; 2006: site 23.



Site 25: 16-21/31/2

Edh-Dhahrah el-Ḥamrah

Israel grid: 1635 2112

UTM grid: 7012 5974

Elevation: 470 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: high ridge

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Einot Safra (Safra

Springs) (no. 137), 600 m distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 400 m distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Dec. 1992; 15 sherds

A small site on a wide ridge (edh-Dhahrah el-Ḥamrah) in the high range south of Nahal 'Iron, close to E.P. 474, about 1 km south-south-west of Mei-'Ami.

At the site a central structure has been preserved, which includes two rooms 5×8 m each, oriented south-south-west, with 0.8 m thick walls. Each of the rooms has a built entrance at one of the corners. In the masonry, an earlier stage of large, hewn stones and a later stage of small field stones can be discerned. In the corner of one of the rooms is a later watchtower built as secondary construction. There is a small sherd scatter in and around

the building, as well as coarse mosaic stones, which come from the dismantling of an agricultural installation or a floor. Around the structure are many agricultural terraces, perhaps connected with a farm that once stood on the spot.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 26: 15-21/60/1

Rujm el-Aḥmar

Israel grid: 1566 2105

UTM grid: 6942 5966

Elevation: 160 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium-sized ruin on tell

Area: 6 dunams (6000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves (partial)

Cisterns: 1

Water source: 'Ein es-Samal

(no. 138), 1.5 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: June 1992; 50 sherds

A medium-sized ruin on a high hilltop in the hilly area south of Nahal 'Iron, 2.2 km west of 'Ar'arah. To the east of the site runs an asphalt road from Nahal 'Iron to Qatzir and Barṭa'ah.

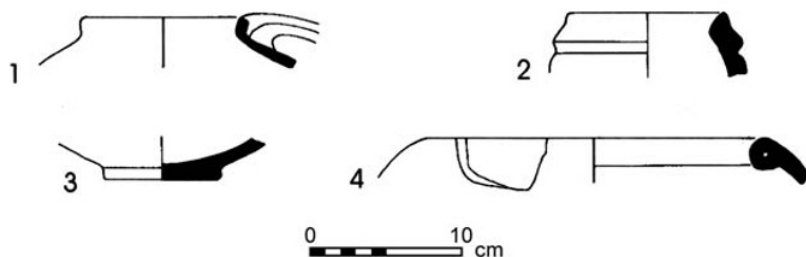
On the high flat hilltop, part of the edh-Dhahrah Range, were found ruins of structures and quarrying. The hilltop had been levelled not long before by a bulldozer to make way for planting trees. After the destruction, building stones and piles of sherds were concentrated at the site. On the eastern part of the hilltop a structure was found, apparently from the Ottoman period. Next to and around it elongated cells with average dimensions of 1.5×0.5×0.5 m were cut into the rock. Their nature and purpose are unclear. At this site are also a cistern and foundations of another structure, about 8×6 m. To the west the area is bordered by a low stone wall, and an unpaved road leading west passes close by. Due to the great destruction it is difficult to determine the nature of the site. It may be that this was a village whose houses were totally demolished, or it may have been a cemetery.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 10%; Iron I-II – 20%; Persian – 20%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 5%; Byzantine – 20%, Modern – 15%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 6; 2006: site 6; Gadot and Tepper 2009: site 299.

Additional Bibliography: Kühner 1989: site 353.



53. Pottery from Ruġm el-Aḥmar: 1.Jug, brn, ER; 2.Jug, gr, IA II; 3.Jug base, brn, MB II; 4.Folded CP, dk brn, MB II.



Site 27: 15-21/70/1

Dabth en-Na'ameh

Israel grid: 1571 2103

UTM grid: 6948 5964

Elevation: 140 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: medium-sized

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: elongated hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein es-Samal
(no. 138), 1 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqā (C14),
at site

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: July 1992; 38 sherds

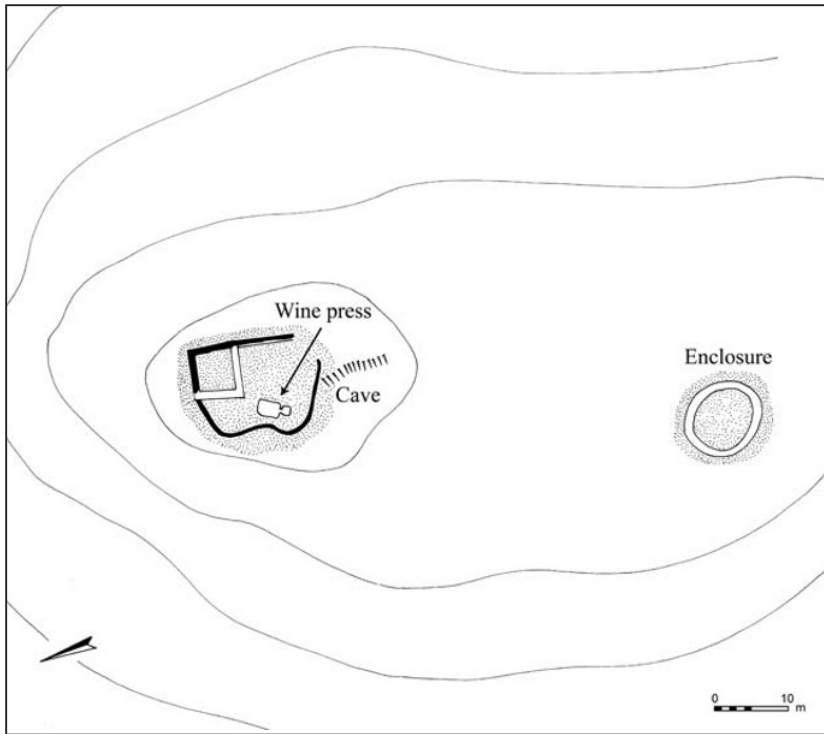
A site (farm?) on a low ridge, west of the Nahal 'Iron – Barṭa'ah road.

The place comprises two parts: In the north, the low top of the hill is surrounded by a wall about 1 m thick. This seems to enclose the farmhouse. In the north-eastern corner there are traces of a building, of which only a wall at a right angle remains, connecting to the surrounding wall. Inside this complex is a winepress and outside it is a cave. About 50 m to the

south-west, on the same ridge, there is a round enclosure with no other architecture. In both places there are medium-sized scatters of sherds.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



54. Plan of Dabth en-Na'ameh, 1997.

Site 28: 15-21/90/1

El-Aḥwat

Israel grid: 1590 2104	Cultivation: olive groves (partial)
UTM grid: 6966 5965	Cisterns: none
Elevation: 325 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Water source: 'Ein Zeituneh
Name type: ancient, but not on map	(no. 139), 500 m distant
Site type: fortified city	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.7 km
Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)	distant
Topography: moderate slope	Visibility: 8
Rock type: Judah group	Date of visit: Oct. 1992; and seven
Soil type: terra rossa	excavation seasons
Soil quality: 5	

A large fortified site on the upper western Qatzir range, within a natural wood, about 500 m west of the centre of Qatzir, and 1 km south of the centre of 'Ar'arah.

This is a good lookout point to the southern Carmel Range, the coastal plain and western Samaria. South of it runs the modern road to Qatzir. The place was excavated during seven seasons (1993–2000 – for a detailed archaeological report see Zertal 2012). The site was divided by its builders into five 'quarters' (denoted A–E for the excavation areas). The excavations were conducted accordingly. The main elements are as follows:

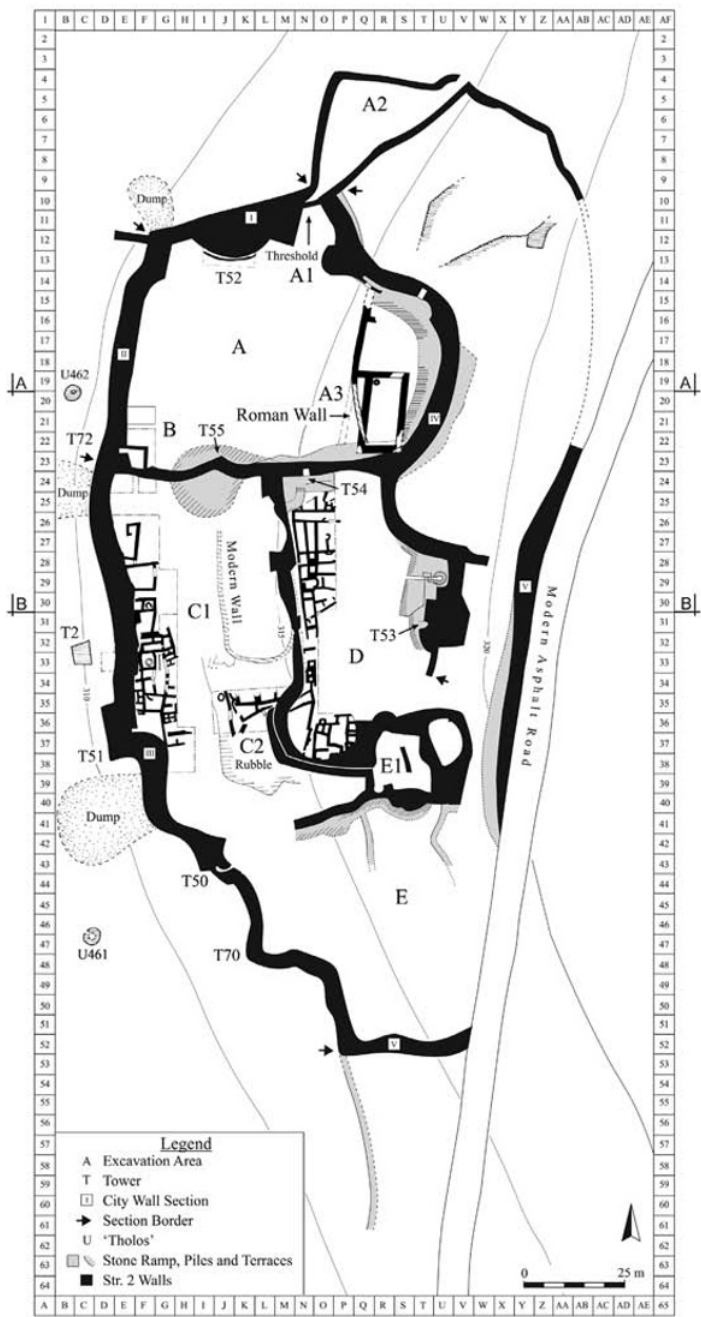
1. Stratigraphy and chronology:

Two distinct strata were discerned at the site: Stratum II, a fortified city of the late 13th–early 12th centuries BCE. This was a developed settlement with a relatively short life span (60–70 years). The city seems to have been founded about 1220 BCE, only to be abandoned not later than 1150 BCE.

Following a long period of abandonment, in the Late Roman/Early Byzantine period (ca. 5th century CE) the place was reused as an agricultural area, most probably a plantation. In this stage (Stratum I) soil was brought to the site from outside, to cover the early buildings and create the base for planting trees. This import was executed with the use of the ancient walls as terraces, while the stones of the early buildings were collected into large piles.

2. Architecture

A. Fortification: The place is enclosed by a stone wall, 5–7 m thick and about 600 m long. It is composed of two walls – outer and inner, with



55. El-Aḥwat – general plan (from Zertal 2012: fig 2.1).

filling between them. The city wall is built in zigzag curved lines, and there are special tower-like constructions at most of the corners. However, only the high eastern tower (T53) is a true tower, whereas the others are merely thickened places along the wall.

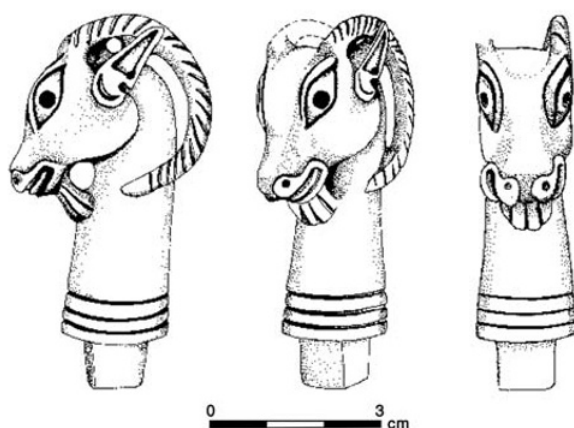
- B. Inner division: The quarters are separated by inner walls, 2 m wide on the average. No entrances or passages between the quarters were detected. The northern quarter, A-B, seems to be the most important, located near the gate, and including the main administrative building complex 100 (Area A3). The other quarters seem to have a functional significance: Area C1 was used as the main dwelling area, and Area D was used as a centre for industrial activity. The function of Area E is unknown. Between Areas A-B and C-D there are two large piles of stones – T54-55. One of them could have been used as a *proto-nuraghe* (cf. below).
- C. The northern gate/entrance: At the northern tip of the site a simple city gate was unearthed, with a triangular area in front of it enclosed by walls. This simple combination has no parallels, nor does it match the massive city wall. It is possible that this was not the main gate of the city.
- D. The dwelling area (Area C1): In Area C1 at least three complexes were excavated, all arranged along and abutting the city wall. The two larger complexes include the northern complex (Com 30), with the partial remains of a possible three-room house, and south of it a 'corridor house' (Com 31) of possible Aegean origin. The latter complex consists of a long corridor with rooms and cells on both sides. In spite of the poor preservation, the plan seems to be clear.
- E. The administrative building (Com 100): In the north-eastern part of Area A the remains of a large construction (25×12 m) enclosed by 2 m-thick walls were exposed. The building was almost completely dismantled during the Roman-Byzantine agricultural activities, but its floor remained, with a rich collection of artifacts. These include Egyptian scarabs, an ivory ibex head, the bronze head of a goddess, etc. These items, together with other considerations, may be interpreted as an indication of the administrative or religious character of the place. Whether it was the seat of the Egyptian governor, or had some other function, is as yet unknown.
- F. Area D and the iron furnace: Area D seems to have been used for industry or workshops. Most prominent is the installation for iron forging, which consisted of a furnace and a working chamber, where iron ore was found. If so, it is one of the earliest of its kind ever found in the southern Levant.
- G. The corridors and *tholoi* (round stone huts): In addition to the other

unique constructions at the site, two architectural features deserve attention. Four corridors, or long niches, were built inside the city wall. They are of different measurements and shapes, but all open into the settlement, having a floor at the elevation of the living surface of the site. Their function is unknown. The second feature consists of round stone-built huts some 2–3 m in diameter and 2 m high. They are roofed, as well as the corridors, in the corbelled dome method. Neither the corridors nor the *tholoi* have been found in other places in the southern Levant, apart from the southern Carmel. In Mt. Carmel, near Kerem Maharal, other sites with features closely resembling these (corridors, etc.) were found. However, there is little information on these sites. With the lack of parallels, both constructions have been compared to West Mediterranean architecture, and see below.

3. Pottery and small finds

Only a few complete vessels were found, due to the orderly abandonment of the place. The pottery is basically local, with only a few imported wares. The pottery tends to be more of the hill-country type than of the valley type of the 13th–12th centuries BCE.

In contrast to the pottery, the amount and quality of the small finds are relatively high. The 12 scarabs found are mostly of Egyptian origin, almost all dating to the 19th–20th Dynasties. In addition, nearly 200 beads were unearthed, many of which are also Egyptian. Special attention should be given to an ivory ibex head, used most probably as a decorative part in the



56. Views of the head of the ivory wild ibex decoration from Area A3 of el-Aḥwat. Drawing by Y. Dekel.



57. Finds from el-Aḥwat. 1. Egyptian seal from the 19th Dynasty. 2. Bronze head of goddess (?) of northern origin (linchpin of a chariot). Photo: Y. Weinberg.

elaborate vessels that were booty, or presents brought from the colonies to the Egyptian court. Other items (bronze head, square seal, cylinder seal, etc.) all date to the 13th century BCE.

Special attention should be paid to the bronze pin with a goddess' (?) head, which was probably used as a chariot linchpin. It may be evidence of the presence of horses and chariots at the site.

4. Environment and economy

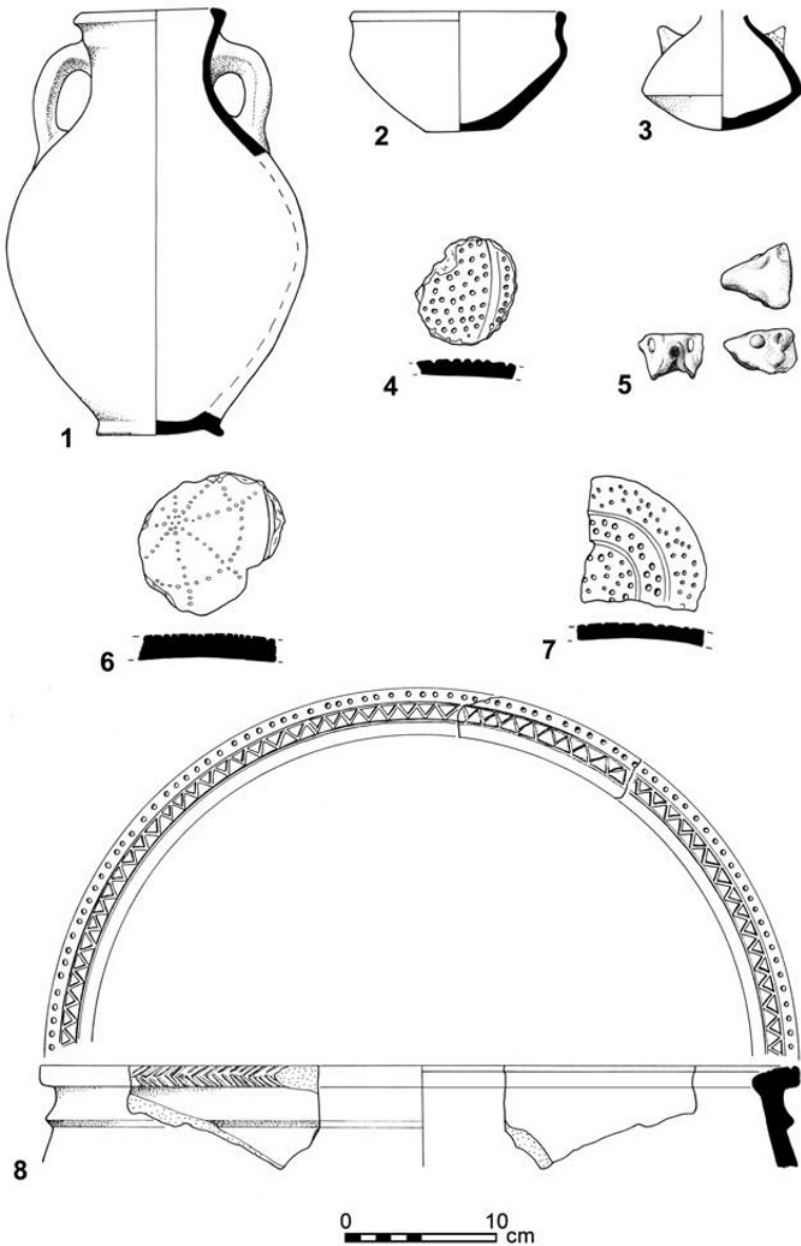
The site was located inside a thick *maquis* of *Quercus* and *Pistacia*, being high, remote and far from roads, water sources, and arable soil. Therefore, it can be assumed that special reasons influenced the founders. In spite of the harsh conditions, the finds indicate a local economy based upon Mediterranean agriculture. This is also indicated by the flint and stone finds, whereas in the animal bones there is a high percentage of fish (Nile perch) that must have reached the site by trade. Hunting played a negligible role.

The two oil presses at the site indicate olive growing, and one of these is of 'northern' (Aegean?) origin.

A strange feature here is the absence of a water source within the site. No spring, water installation, or cisterns were found. In addition, the percentage of collared-rim pithoi, assumed to be the water storage vessels of the Iron Age I is relatively low. Until now, no satisfactory explanation has been suggested for the water issue.

5. The possible origin of the settlers of el-Aḥwat

The site presents a series of unique characteristics, which makes it difficult to understand. It is the sole fortified city of this size and sophistication



58. Pottery from el-Aḥwat (all from Iron Age I): 1. Jug, brn; 2. Bowl, gr; 3. Pyxis, brn; 4, 6-7. Baking platters, dk brn; 5. Ceramic head of bull; 8. Krater with incised dec, yel and gr.